

SAOLOTO CAMPAIGN STRATEGY

Professional Higher Technical Course in Digital Marketing

Campaign Strategy and Planning

Saoloto Surf School

Business Case

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Project word document:

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1nyJL0La-Y9aVfhH8O77bKwNDdBvpBbzNKygbAtj7XVI/edit?usp=sharing>

“Saoloto Data” document:

https://www.canva.com/design/DAG923xfnO4/rDgyWMdHXR1ZP_Df0Cb5pg/edit?utm_content=DAG923xfnO4&utm_campaign=designshare&utm_medium=link2&utm_source=sharebutton

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1. ■ Introduction

1.1 Saoloto - The Origin

During Genesis at our surf school, the ultimate objective was to guarantee a genuineness whose equal has never been seen.

This obsession with creating a “brand” with these levels of focus on what is genuine and authentic requires a name as authentic as the space, the teaching and the “Vibes”.

The surfing that this school aims to promote is strongly influenced by the roots of surfing, which the world saw born in 400 AD on the sands of French Polynesia, a sport that was once considered the sport of kings, which in the 12th century was already represented in cave paintings in the form of He’e Nalu (Booth, n.d.).

A form of expression that saw its existence threatened upon the arrival of European missionaries on the continent in 1820, who considered the activity as lazy and a waste of time and had to wait until the end of the 20th century to see its popularity resurfaced by the “Beach Boys of Waikiki”, Duke Kahanamoku (The father of modern surfing) in particular (Soft Surfboards®, n.d.).

The only thing we knew was that the name would have to be authentically Polynesian (original language of surfing), it would have to be a word that represented the core value of the surfing and he would have to ensure that no one who heard him could remain indifferent to him. It would have to immediately convey a clear message about what, as a school, we value; would have to be representative of the essence we look for in all the people we meet. they look for us; it would have to honor all the figures and cultures that brought surfing to us; would have above all, represent the feeling of freedom that these heroes have always fought for preserve.

It would have to be Freedom.

It would have to be Saoloto.

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1.2 The Project

The present work aims to propose a go-to-market strategy (GTM) for a surf school located in Costa de Caparica, Saoloto Surf School. For this end, the development of the project was structured into three distinct moments.

In a first phase, a comprehensive analysis was carried out, focusing on either on the school's external environment, including the market, both nationally and international level, competition, target audience and surf culture, whether on the environment internal, centered on the organization itself.

As Saoloto Surf School is a fictitious brand, the internal analysis showed limitations in terms of available information, which led to the second phase of the project: the creation of the brand and the development of the respective brand guidelines. At this stage, there were elements of a strategic and emotional nature are addressed, such as the Golden Circle, as well as more operational components, such as the marketing mix, among other fundamental elements for the structure and coherence of the project.

The objective was to build a true “bible” of the brand, fundamental to guarantee an identity and communication differentiated from the competition, supported by the consistency and coherence that this type of model provides.

Finally, considering that the curricular unit focuses on campaign strategy, the brand's ecosystem was developed and, consequently, all pieces of communication considered relevant to a project whose purpose is market entry.

In this way, the work presents a structure with a beginning, middle and end, seeking address the main critical points of an organized go-to-market strategy, based on each decision made and, above all, aligned with the needs of the market, target audience and business logic.

2. ■ Development

2.1 4C'S Worksheet - Strategic Analysis

In order to provide a rigorous and organized structure to the analysis phase, we chose by applying the 4C'S Worksheet framework (image 1 in the annex). This methodology

allows a clear segmentation of the different dimensions of the analysis, covering both the internal and external environment. This division allows for a targeted focus on each category, generating ideas and insights that prove to be fundamental at different moments in the project, from building the brand identity to defining the operational strategy.

By using this tool, it is ensured that the analysis is not just descriptive, but rather a strategic basis for future decisions.

2.1.1 Company Analysis

This category focuses specifically on the Saoloto Surf School brand. Treating yourself of a project in the creation phase and of an academic nature, a retrospective and performance would not be viable, which would initially justify omitting this step.

However, there is already a clear vision of the intended positioning for the brand, fruit of the authors' experience and initial exploratory research, it presents itself as followed by SWOT analysis. The identified points reflect the scenario projected for the internal and external environment of a surf school in Costa da Caparica (initially in Cascais), with a strategic orientation focused on the international market, as defined in the briefing.

It is important to note that, although the Marketing Mix is fundamental to presentation of a brand, its details were reserved for a later stage.

It is considered essential to first consolidate public and competitive analysis, ensuring that product development, distribution strategy, communication with personas and pricing policy are built on a solid and differentiating foundation.

These aspects will be duly developed in section 2.2.1, dedicated to Marketing Mix.

2.1.1.1 SWOT Analysis

The SWOT Analysis presented systematizes the critical factors that will influence the performance of Saoloto Surf School. This analysis allows you to cross-reference internal competencies with market conditions, defining the basis for the growth strategy.

It is important to note that the content shared below is not definitive and may undergo changes throughout the development of the project, given that the structure of the work follows the dynamics of the planning process itself. Therefore, whether the options

be revised later on, or those that are consolidated, will find their justification detailed in the relevant chapters.

Internal

External

Strengths

Opportunities

1: Community:

The focus on the feeling of belonging and creating a community encourages loyalty and marketing organic

(word-of-mouth),

vital

in

tourism

experience

1: Growth of surf tourism globally:

The global growth of surfing as a lifestyle attracts a segment of tourists who value contact with the nature and authentic experiences.

2: Strategic Location:

The proximity to Greater Lisbon, combined with the consistent surf of Costa da Caparica, as well as the surrounding space, offers a logistical and... competitive.

2: Democratization via Wave Pools:

The proliferation of wave pools reduces the “barrier to enter”, creating a new flow of practitioners that, of course, wait, they will transit to the open sea.

3: Qualified and Experienced Instructors:

Professionals with international experience, recognized in reference surfing destinations, such as Hawaii, Australia and California provide a value proposition authentic and differentiating.

This

diversity

of

origins

and

experiences

brings

authenticity to the school and enriches the experience of

students, who not only learn the technique, but also

the culture, values and spirit of surfing.

3: Potential of influencer marketing:

In a world increasingly taken over by AI and content

without a soul or a human face, the visual character of surfing

power

partnerships

strategic

with creators of

content, maximizing brand visibility.

4: Multitude of Business Facets:

The ability to diversify the offer through events,

retreats and branded products (for example) expands the

revenue sources and brand recognition in certain

niches linked to the sea/beach/surf.

4: Diversification in low season periods:

The school can maintain active operations outside of the summer with

parallel activities such as surf camps,

well-being

or

classes

indoor,

reducing

like this

to

seasonality.

5: Adaptation to various surfing levels:

5: Merchandise is an avenue to develop:

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An offer adapted to different levels and profiles of surfers allows the capture of a broad spectrum of customers.

The expansion potential for e-commerce and sales physical appearance of branded products reinforces the notoriety and complementary income (Earned Media in a certain way too).

Weaknesses

Threats

1: Susceptibility to atmospheric conditions:

The high susceptibility to sea and sea conditions time can generate instability operational and consequently in the flow of reserves.

1: Macroeconomic Instability:

Inflationary pressures and rising costs operations can reduce purchasing power and profit margins.

2: Less international notoriety:

Compared to consolidated centers such as Ericeira or Peniche, the brand faces the challenge of building authority in the national market and, subsequently, international.

2: Growth of Wave Pools as an alternative

indoor:

The proliferation of artificial swimming pools could divert part of public beginner, that

search

experiences

controlled and convenient, reducing demand for the sea open.

3: Reduced operational capacity:

A structure in the start-up phase may limit the responsiveness during peak demand seasonal.

3:

Change

of

habits

and

expectations

of

consumers:

The modern tourist seeks personalized and sustainable; schools that do not adapt to this trend lose relevance.

4: High initial investment in marketing:

The need for a strong initial financial contribution in SEO, influencers, partnerships and digital channels for compete with established operators.

4: Environmental Risks:

Sea level rise and climate change can modify the morphology of beaches and the quality of local waves.

5: Accentuated Seasonality:

The search for surfing lessons tends to be concentrated in spring and summer months, which creates fluctuations in revenue and challenges in maintaining teams and operations during the “low season”.

5: Increase in insurance “premiums”:

To “protect” the school and students. That can

justify, unfortunately, the increase in the monetary value
of the products.

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2.1.2 - Market Analysis

Market analysis constitutes a fundamental step in defining a effective go-to-market strategy, as it allows understanding the context in which the brand you want to insert. Through this analysis, it is possible to identify trends, opportunities and constraints in the sector, as well as evaluating the behavior of the consumer, competitive dynamics and external factors that influence demand. In the context of this project, market analysis assumes particular relevance for supporting strategic decisions related to the positioning of Saoloto Surf School, ensuring that the value proposition, communication and marketing actions are aligned with the real needs of the market and the expectations of the target audience.

2.1.2.1 Market - Surfing

Surfing is an activity with a long history, whose origins date back to 400 AD, as already mentioned. Over time, it was adopted by different cultures and evolved until it became become a global practice. Therefore, it is a widely consolidated market at a international, its analysis must consider this broad dimension. However, given that the Saoloto Surf School will be based in Portugal, it is equally essential to read the national reality.

The main challenge lies in access to updated data: many studies are pre-pandemic, some reports are not public and the most recent statistics show significant gaps between them. Thus, whenever information about Portugal is non-existent or insufficient, this absence will be explained, using available data, such as form of contextualization, even though these may lack precision for the current scenario. Despite these limitations, the articulation between global and national analysis allows understand the level of competitiveness, the existing offer and the possible positioning for Saoloto, aspects that will be deepened and complemented in the analysis of the competition. A international level, we seek above all to understand what stage the market is at, whether it is one of expansion, innovation or stabilization based on tradition. This framework will be fundamental to assess the growth potential of Saoloto Surf School. Starting from this analytical framework, we then proceed to characterize the global surfing market.

The available data present very different estimates regarding the total number of active surfers in the world. The most recent reference, dated 2024, continues to use the 2012 estimate, which pointed to around 35 million practitioners (Armstrong & Dickerson, 2024). The lack of updated numbers may be related with the very informality and fluidity of surf culture, which suggests that the real value may be currently higher, especially considering recent growth trends (discussed in point 2.1.2.6 - trends) .

The reliability of these numbers remains limited because the concept of “surfer asset” is not defined consistently across different sources. One of the few explicit definitions, presents a distinction between a “casual” surfer, understood as “anyone who has surfed at least once during the year”, and a “core” surfer, described as “someone who surfed more than eight times during the year” (STAB, 2016). No However, it is not possible to confirm whether the remaining sources adopt these same criteria, a since they do not clarify how they classify practitioners. Therefore, it is not known whether an individual who owns a board but hardly uses it, or someone who only surfs a few times per year, is counted in the same way as a regular practitioner. These ambiguities make it difficult to precisely define the target audience and highlight the need for Saoloto collect own data over time, in order to build a more detailed characterization reliable and suited to the reality of your market.

Continuing the analysis, according to existing estimates, of the 35 million surfers, around 13.5 million are in North and South America, 6.5 million in Oceania, 6 million in Asia and 4.5 million in Europe. In terms of countries, the United States counts with approximately 3 million practitioners, Australia with 1.7 million and the United Kingdom United with around 500 thousand. Portugal appears in sixth European position, with approximately 200 thousand surfers (Pinto, n.d.).

Discrepancies are equally notable in the estimated value of the global market.

One of the sources points to 9.82 billion euros in 2025, with annual growth 6.3% by 2032 (Coherent Market Insights, 2025); another estimates 71.93 billion, predicting growth of 12.3% by 2035, potentially reaching 157.56 billion (Future Marketing Insight, 2025). Despite the differences, both confirm a tendency towards consistent expansion, driven by several factors that will be explored later.

In the case of Portugal, projections suggest a market valued at 2,344 million of dollars, with an estimated growth of 7.2% until 2030, the year in which it could reach 3,566 million. If these predictions are confirmed, Portugal will become, by the end of the decade, the European country with the highest revenue in the sector, reinforcing the attractiveness of the market national for new projects (Grand View Horizon, n.d.).

Regarding market segments, one of the first distinctions is between surf domestic and international. Surfing practiced within the country represents between 68% and 71% of the market share, which reveals a clear preference among consumers to remain in their usual context, benefiting from lower costs, greater convenience and absence of cultural barriers (Coherent Market Insights, 2025). International surfing, although it represents around 30%, is also growing, particularly among practitioners coming from countries without a consolidated surfing culture or without natural conditions favorable. For foreign operators (such as Saoloto), these segments represent a opportunity, since national competition does not exist, and they are more likely to spend more money than locals (Future Marketing Insight, 2025).

In the Portuguese case (image 2 in the annex), there is no data indicating how many of the 200 thousand surfers practice outside or only within the country, but existing data on tourists who visit Portugal to surf, mostly Europeans, show a relevant potential (Calheiros, 2018). Markets such as the United States or Australia, from which surfing has historically expanded, remain underrepresented in tourism surfing in Portugal, which opens up a strategic opportunity: either to attract surfers originating from these markets, differentiating themselves from national competition, or to explore these destinations at a later stage, when the brand has greater notoriety and authority.

With regard to the consumer profile, international data indicate that around 65.8% of surfers are men, a value influenced by cultural factors and the image historically associated with surfing (Coherent Market Insights, 2025). However, the Women have risen to prominence, in part due to the growing influence of public figures and content creators who promote more inclusive surfing. In terms of age, the group between 26 and 35 years old represents approximately 40% of the market, a stage of life in which there is a greater balance between financial capacity, physical availability and flexibility of time (Future Marketing Insight, 2025).

In Portugal (image 2 in the annex), the most relevant data, even if dated 2018, suggest that 99% of practitioners are men, of which 78.6% are between 15 and 34 years old (Calheiros, 2018). Considering that almost ten years have passed, it is expected that the age distribution is close to the international context, especially between 25 and 44 years old. As for women, although they represented less than 1% at the time, global growth of this segment and the role of current influencers make them too relevant to be ignored in Saoloto's communication.

Another segmentation criterion refers to the type of tourist. The market is divided between solo travelers, “backpackers” and group tourism, the latter being the most significant, with approximately 61.9% (Coherent Market Insights, 2025). The groups are mostly made up of beginners looking for structured, safe and convenient experiences, characteristics that a school with a good reputation can guarantee. Travelers Individuals tend to be more experienced, valuing specific challenges and selecting their experiences more accurately. Although both can generate word-of-mouth, the Individual surfers, due to their experience, tend to have greater influence within the community. Still, groups represent greater value by choosing packages complete and prolonged activities.

In Portugal, data from 2018 points to a preference among surfers nationals for surfing with friends, but learning self-taught, only 11.6% they turn to schools (Calheiros, 2018). These numbers should be interpreted with caution, since the study covered only 2503 surfers (1.25% of the estimated 200 thousand), and is It is likely that the sample is biased towards less dense regions, such as Algarve or Costa Alentejana, where there are fewer schools and a greater concentration of more experienced surfers. Finally, seasonality (image 3 in the annex) is another relevant element. From According to 2022 sources, the best time to surf varies depending on the continent, country and the level of experience of the practitioner. Generally speaking, beginners or occasional surfers they prefer the hottest months, when the sea is calmer, the days are long and the water it's hotter. Experienced surfers tend to favor months with cooler conditions. challenging (Drughi, 2022).

In Portugal (image 3 in the annex), the period between October and April offers the best waves for advanced surfers, due to the greater consistency of the “swells” resulting from the North Atlantic storms. For starters, spring and summer (May to September)

provide ideal conditions, with warmer waters and a climate conducive to use diversity of beaches (Drughi, 2022). This duality demonstrates that Saoloto can operate throughout the year, as long as it offers more than surf lessons, diversifying products and services.

Despite the limitations of available data, much of which predates the pandemic, all sources converge on one essential point: the global surfing market continues to grow, and Portugal asserts itself as one of the main drivers of this expansion in Europe. It is therefore, it is expected that the real number of surfers, both internationally and nationally, is today higher than that recorded in older studies.

Practitioners looking for international experiences, around 30% of the total, represent a clear opportunity, especially those from landlocked or landlocked countries. surfing tradition, like Germany, Switzerland or Austria. In Asia, China's growing interest stands out as a sign of future potential (Coherent Market Insights, 2025). Markets traditionally strong countries such as the United States and Australia maintain their strategic value, although they may require a more differentiated approach due to strong local competition.

In behavioral terms, it is observed that beginners tend to join groups, while experienced surfers mostly travel solo or in small groups, which reinforces the importance of developing different products for each segment.

Finally, although the market continues to be predominantly male, the growth in female participation transforms this segment into a relevant opportunity, where inclusion and representation can constitute differentiating factors for Saoloto Surf School.

2.1.2.2 Presentation of the Competition

Once the functioning of the market is understood, it becomes necessary to analyze the level of competition. This analysis allows us to understand how different surf schools operate: what products they offer, how they communicate and through what channels, among others important points for the construction of the SSS. Therefore, the objective of this section is to provide a solid basis for defining the pillars of the marketing mix and brand guidelines that will distinguish Saoloto Surf School in the market.

Before proceeding to the analysis of selected competitors, it is important to justify the changing the location initially planned for Saoloto, complementing it with a overview of the panorama of surf schools in Portugal.

The original physical location defined for Saoloto was Cascais. However, after a preliminary analysis, it became evident that this choice would not be suitable for the objectives project strategies.

According to a specialized information agency (not a Portuguese body official), there are approximately 678 surf schools in Portugal. The three regions with The largest concentrations are: Costa da Caparica (62 schools), Ericeira (32) and Carcavelos (29). Cascais only comes in ninth place, with 13 schools (PoiData.io, 2025).

At first glance, Cascais may seem like a more prestigious location, while Costa da Caparica may seem less appealing. However, it is essential to analyze only the absolute number of schools, but also the available coastal area and the way in which These schools are distributed throughout this area.

Cascais has a coastline of around 30 kilometers (Cascais, n.d.).

However, a significant part of this coast does not correspond to beach areas. How is it possible to check through Google maps (image 4 in the annex), much of the coastline is composed of cliffs, cliffs, urban areas or marinas. The result is that Cascais has only five beaches, relatively small and, in most cases, inserted in a context urban, which limits the creation of a distinctive experience.

In contrast, Costa da Caparica presents characteristics more aligned with the project proposal. The different sources consulted vary in terms of length total coastline, estimated between 15 and 35 kilometers, but regardless of the exact value, it is a coast made entirely of sand. As we move away from the urban core (closer to Lisbon), the beaches become progressively more surrounded by green areas, giving the place a more natural, wild and less urban, even though the distance to the capital remains reduced (images 5 and 6 in the annex).

This distance also influences the distribution of schools: the greater the distance from the central area, the lower the concentration of schools, as illustrated in image 7 of the annex. Observation of the spatial distribution confirms that the majority of schools is concentrated in the initial section of the coast, close to the urban area, where they are located

lots of restaurants, shops, hotels and terminal points for various transport routes public.

In this way, Costa da Caparica presents a large space for exploration, not exploration that leads to the exchange of existing green space for something usable, which implies the destruction of that same space, but for the construction of something that uses the space environment as a “prop” to create an environment that matches surf culture, culture, which will be explored later, in point 2.1.3 Analysis of Culture, which will serve as also as reinforcement to justify this exchange between locations.

Having justified the future physical location of Saoloto, the next step is to present the competition. This analysis was segmented into 3, direct, indirect and potential competition.

2.1.2.2.1 Direct Competition

Direct competition comprises entities that the brand identifies as a immediate threat, as they operate in the same market, target the same target audience and offer very similar services that satisfy the same needs. This typology of competition explicitly competes for the attention, preference and purchasing decision of the consumer.

For this analysis, three distinct brands were selected based on a criteria of geographic diversification. With Saoloto aiming to capture the international market, selection included references such as Outtheback (due to its strong external reach); the relevance competitiveness of the Cascais hub justified the inclusion of a representative player of this region; and finally, given the extent and importance of Costa da Caparica, the competition from greater geographic proximity.

Below is a detailed contextualization of each:

2.1.2.2.1.1 Gecko Surf School (Costa da Caparica)

Link: <https://geckosurfschool.com/en/>

Gecko Surf School, founded in 2016, is a surf school located in Praia de Santo António, in Costa da Caparica. The mission of this school is to provide experiences memorable and transformative experiences through surfing, promoting connections with nature, personal confidence and a healthy lifestyle (Gecko Surf School, n.d.). Offers classes for beginners and advanced surfers, as well as equipment rental.

Competitiveness Relationship: This constitutes a direct threat due to its occupation geographic location and ease of access for those looking to practice the sport in close to Lisbon. Although its service portfolio does not fully reflect the breadth that the Saoloto project intends to have (especially in terms of the Surf Camp more structured), its strong local presence competes directly for the same segment of students.

Strategic Challenge: The challenge for Saoloto here is not just technical, but also perception of freshness: while Gecko is the "school as usual", Saoloto must position itself as the "evolution of experience".

Critical Differentiation: Another observation concerns communication. Despite mention that the connection with nature (Gecko Surf School, n.d.) is one of the pillars that intend to provide as a brand, visual communication does not suggest this, very probably due to the location that does not facilitate this connection. A point that at Saoloto will be reinforced, due to the advantage that the recommended location provides to the project.

2.1.2.2.1.2 Surf Cascais (Cascais)

Link: <https://www.surfcascais.com/pt>

Surf Cascais is a surf school located in Cascais, whose product is mainly the Surf Camp, a format that combines daily surf classes, accommodation in a community and social activities, creating a total immersion in the surfing lifestyle.

The school offers classes for all levels, from beginners to surfers intermediate courses, led by certified instructors.

The accommodation, known as Surf House, is a space located in Murches, just minutes from the beaches of Cascais. It has a swimming pool, lounge areas, kitchen shared rooms and rooms, designed to promote coexistence between surfers from different nationalities and create a true community.

In addition to classes and accommodation, Surf Cascais also offers complete packages that include transportation, breakfast, equipment rental and social events, positioning itself as an ideal option for tourists and travelers looking for a complete and carefree surfing experience.

Competitiveness Relationship: Surf Cascais stands out for the maturity of its service ecosystem. Its strength lies in offering a range of highly structured and complementary, which allow an effective upselling strategy (hosting + classes + social experiences). This ability to sell an integrated experience is very similar to the value proposition planned for Saoloto Surf School, making them a direct competitor in the dispute for the surf tourist's share of pocket.

Strategic Challenge: Saoloto's competitive advantage will lie in its narrative brand and the "escapism" provided by the location. While Surf Cascais operates in a more urban and conventional context, Saoloto differentiates itself through a visual communication deeply linked to nature and the culture of freedom inspired by Samoan spirit. The challenge is to position the project as a paradisiacal, humble and disconnected from the pressure of the modern world. By transforming the privileged location into a differentiation asset, Saoloto stops being just "another school" and becomes a destination of authenticity, something that the more mass offer in Cascais cannot achieve replicate.

2.1.2.2.1.3 Outtheback (New Zealand)

Link: <https://www.outtheback.nz/>

Based in the South Island of New Zealand, Outtheback (OTB) is a reference international in teaching surfing in remote and difficult to access locations. Its offer focuses on group surf camps and personalized trips that focus on exclusivity and contact direct to the virgin nature of New Zealand's west and south coast.

Competitive Relationship: OTB is considered a direct competitor in the plan of international reach. In the decision-making journey of an international tourist, it is expected that the choice begins with selecting the destination and experience. Given that the Saoloto aims to convert this foreign audience, the brand competes directly with OTB for the attention of consumers searching for "authentic and remote areas" worldwide.

Strategic Challenge: The challenge for Saoloto is to elevate its positioning to that is perceived not only as a local option in Portugal, but as a global authority in surf teaching. The OTB analysis allows us to identify good practices in communication of "wild" destinations and the curation of private trips, serving as

inspiration for Saoloto to replicate this feeling of exclusivity and adventure in South Bank.

Digital Differentiation: To compete with players of this caliber, Saoloto must invest in an SEO and content marketing strategy that positions it as the alternative European Union to the OTB model. The objective is to intercept the client in the planning phase, demonstrating that it is possible to find the same philosophy of freedom and "remote places" just minutes from a European capital, such as Lisbon.

These are some examples of direct competing brands. As stated, they were chosen based on a geographical criterion, but among different possibilities, these were those chosen because they demonstrate the path that Saoloto will follow.

Gecko represents the importance of a sense of community and implementation location. As the community is one of the most valuable assets in the surfing market, Gecko serves as a example on how to create close bonds with the practitioner.

Surf Cascais is proof of concept that, in Portugal, it is possible to operate a structured and profitable project. It represents the level of operational maturity that Saoloto aims to achieve, serving as a basis for the development of its processes.

Outtheback functions as the aspirational horizon. Its global reach and brand authority are Saoloto's long-term objective, positioning it not only as a local school, but as a reference in the global market of learning experiences surfing.

Finally, it is important to mention that in continuous work with the brand, this analysis must be more extensive, not only in terms of analyzing these brands, but also others, since that the objective will always be to stand out in the market, and in terms of business objective, to sell as many vacancies as possible, every year. For academic purposes, these were examples of direct competition.

2.1.2.2.2 Indirect Competition

Indirect competition is made up of all entities that, although not offer surf teaching as a main activity, satisfy the same basic need consumer: the search for well-being, outdoor leisure and connection with nature. For the Saoloto project, indirect competition represents the challenge of competing for share of wallet

(available budget) and the tourist's share of time (vacation time). A potential customer Those who visit Costa da Caparica have a limited time; every hour dedicated to a class Yoga, a boat trip or a meditation retreat is a time when you are not consume Saoloto services.

Below are the brands chosen for analysis:

2.1.2.2.1 Ocean Yoga Studio (Costa da Caparica)

Link: <https://www.oceanyogastudio.pt/>

Ocean Yoga Studio is a studio located in Costa da Caparica that combines yoga, meditation and well-being practices close to the sea.

The studio offers face-to-face classes and retreats, integrating different styles of yoga, from Vinyasa to Yin, and moments of relaxation that value calm, breathing and the energy of the ocean.

In addition to classes, Ocean Yoga Studio positions itself as a community space and sharing, promoting workshops, events and joint practices that reinforce the connection between participants and the surrounding natural environment. The sea and the beach function as elements symbolic and physical signs of renewal and serenity, reinforcing the studio's purpose: to offer transformative experiences that unite yoga, well-being and the free spirit of Costa da Caparica.

Competitive Relationship: This brand represents indirect competition, since, although its general objective is to promote the feeling of community among participants, your proposal is based on a distinct activity. Just like surfing, yoga offers significant psychological benefits, namely the ability to disconnect from routine and reconnect with yourself. Furthermore, the sharing and contact environment between individuals with different backgrounds and experiences is one of the brand's core values, approaching our philosophy.

Strategic Challenge: The differentiating point in relation to indirect competition lies in the nature of the activity: while yoga and surfing provide benefits similar on an emotional and social level, the public's choice will depend on what they are looking for primarily, the physical aspect or the emotional experience. In the latter case, Saoloto

positions itself as a relevant competitor, by offering an experience equally transformative, even if through a different practice.

2.1.2.2.2 Bolhas Tours (Sesimbra, Setúbal, Portugal)

Link: <https://www.bolhas tours.com/pt/>

Bolhas Tours has been operating since 2013, based in the Port of Abrigo de Sesimbra (Setúbal Peninsula, Portugal), and specializes in nautical experiences, such as boat trips boat for dolphin and whale watching, coastal tours, boat rental, fishing, and leisure activities for groups or companies.

The brand stands out for its strong appeal to the connection with the sea, with biodiversity and with the coastal landscape, taking advantage of the Arrábida region, caves and rock formations of the coast of Sesimbra.

Bolhas Tours aims to provide memorable leisure moments for families, friends or corporate events.

Competitive Relationship: It is considered indirect competition because, although does not offer surfing lessons, operates in the same geographic territory (Arrábida/Sesimbra region) and within the same tourism sector of experiences linked to the sea. Both brands they essentially sell “time at sea and connection with nature”, aimed at a public looking for authentic, relaxed and memorable water activities, many sometimes in the context of leisure, vacations or group events.

Strategic Challenge: The difference is in the form of the experience (surfing vs. boat), but the emotional objective is the same: to provide pleasure, relaxation and connection to the ocean. Therefore, in the consumer decision funnel, both may appear as alternatives direct to those looking for “what to do at sea on the Lisbon/Setúbal Coast”.

2.1.2.2.3 Potential Competition

Potential competition refers to “new entrants”: brands or technologies that do not yet operate directly in Saoloto’s territory, but they have the resources, the motivation and strategic relevance to do so in the near future. For the Saoloto project, This group represents the risk of disruption.

In the surfing market, potential competition does not only come in the form of new traditional schools, but rather through innovative business models that change the way how the consumer lives the surfing experience (e.g. artificial wave technology) or through of large hotel chains that decide to verticalize their offer, creating their own teaching structures, for example.

2.1.2.2.3.1 Surfers Cove (Óbidos, Portugal)

Link: <https://surferscove.pt/>

Surfers Cove is a large project located in Óbidos, which intends to create a surf resort with an artificial wave pool equipped with Wavegarden Cove technology, capable of generating up to a thousand waves per hour. The inauguration is scheduled for 2026. The space will occupy around five hectares and will include accommodation, restaurant, surf school, shop, skate park, padel and beach tennis courts, gym and areas greens.

The project positions itself as an international surfing center, designed both for high-performance training and learning in a controlled and safe environment, attracting tourists, families and surfers of different levels. Premium and complete offer, which combines sport, tourism and well-being.

Competitive Relationship: Constitutes potential competition for schools surfing, since although the main focus is tourism and the integrated resort experience, shares the same universe of values, contact with the sea, learning and community surfer, being able to influence public expectations in terms of quality, infrastructure and experience.

Strategic Challenge: The central challenge lies in the distinction between convenience technological and the authenticity of the organic experience. Although values may be shared, the surrounding environment at Surfers Cove is very different from a beach, which could mean that a niche in this market (those who prefer contact with nature, or “escapism”) will not be affected. For Saoloto, this potential threat becomes a opportunity for differentiation: while technology replicates the movement of the wave, Saoloto offers the essence of freedom and the rawness of nature, pillars that technology has not yet can emulate.

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2.1.2.3 Benchmarking

After the presentation of the competition, the benchmarking process began, for a comparative systematization of the selected brands. The main objective of this step is to compare them according to a set of previously defined criteria, allowing at a later stage, identify the key points of the market.

This comparison makes it possible to understand which practices can be adopted, which ones can be optimized compared to the competition and which ones should not be replicated.

Image 8 - Benchmarking of competing brands, 3rd slide of the “Saoloto Data” portfolio

Given the results found, some insights were drawn:



Expensive prices = different targets: According to superficial analysis

culture (later developed and justified in point 2.1.3.1. Target audience - Culture and Behavior) the surfers that Saoloto aims to reach are travelers, explorers.

They have a controlled budget, prioritize the value of the experience and try to make the most of what the world has the best, in this case, the ocean. The other segments are also important for Saoloto, but in Portugal this will be the project that will offer the best ratio "experience-value".



Surf Camp: As it is an offer widely adopted by the majority of competition, it is essential that any surf school makes it available, since enhances the creation of long-term relationships and a community, thanks to the period prolonged interaction between the public and the brand.



Digital Presence: This is another area in which competition highlights, in general, good practices, not only due to the diversity of platforms used, but also for consistency in the production and publication of content. However, it is important to highlight some differentiating aspects already identified. For one hand, visual communication appears as a factor in which Saoloto has an advantage competitive compared to other players. On the other hand, there is a relevant gap in the use of influencers: most of the competition does not integrate, in a structured way, surfers or lifestylers who practice surfing regularly in their surfing strategies communication. This absence represents a clear opportunity for the project to stand out, since collaboration with influencers can bring significant benefits to brands, such as in terms of credibility, reach and impact on sales.



Branding over performance: From the perspective of building a community and sustainable business development, maximizing lifetime value (LTV) of the consumer requires that the brand strategy override the purely logical logic sales transactional. Communication should focus on the environment, emotions and experiences associated with activities, covering the pre, during and post-experience phases. References to prices should be avoided throughout the funnel, appearing only in the conversion (BOFU), at which point the lead has already developed a connection with the brand and recognizes this bond as the main decision factor in choosing Saoloto Surf School.

2.1.2.4 Porter Forces

Continuing with the market analysis, and after consolidating the benchmarking, the "Porter Forces" framework was used. This model, developed by Michael Porter, aims to analyze the five forces that, together, determine the attractiveness and long-term profitability of an industry.

In the context of this project, and after presenting the market situation and its main players, this analysis functions as a critical synthesis. Its purpose is

double: on the one hand, consolidate the key points already identified and, on the other, cement the strategic viability of Saoloto, demonstrating the solidity of the project in the face of the dynamics and pressures from the surfing sector.

Strength

Intensity

(High/Moderate

/Low)

Justification

1. Rivalry

between

competitors

High

Competitiveness in the sector, as already demonstrated, is accentuated by the high operator density: there are currently 678 surf schools in Portugal, of which 62 operate in Costa da Caparica. This saturation of local market demands that Saoloto distance itself from direct rivalry through of a distinctive positioning:

- While traditional competition competes for the "student of occasion" on the beach, Saoloto focuses on "experiential tourism".

- By positioning itself as the "evolution of experience", the brand avoids direct price competition (common among local schools such as Gecko), competing rather for the superiority of service and environment.

2. Threat of

new entrants

Low/moderate As with rivalry, with this level of competition, any business that is planning to enter this market will have to reconsider attractiveness of this sector. Since the objective of any business is to sustainability (financial) this high level of competitors makes this quite difficult.

On the other hand, there are other issues that require more than just the intention to operate:

- Legal and Regulatory Barriers: This is the most critical barrier.

The operation of a surf school requires specific licensing,

such as the Porto Captaincy, the Portuguese Institute of Sports and Youth (IPDJ) and Tourism of Portugal. The number of licenses to operate on certain beaches is often limited and strictly supervised, which prevents entry uncontrolled growth of new operators.

●■ Initial Investment and Capital Requirements: Entry into market requires a relevant investment in fixed assets: fleet of vans for transport, stock of boards and suits of various sizes and, in the case of Saoloto, the infrastructure for the Surf Camp and

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the cafeteria. This initial capital cost acts as a filter for adventurers without financial strength.

In short, despite the existing rivalry, it is not so simple for new competitors, which demonstrates the opportunity, probably unique in the near future, for a project like the Saoloto Surf School.

3. Power

negotiation of

suppliers

Moderate

Given the diverse nature of the project, the power of suppliers was analyzed across Saoloto's three business fronts:

●■ Teaching (Classes and Camps): Power is medium. Taking into account the market for certified surf instructors that is robust in areas high influx of surfers (greater demand for lessons and followed by greater supply of instructors).

●■ Technical Equipment (Sale and Rental): The power is high. O high performance material market is dominated by a group restricted from global brands (e.g. Rip Curl, Quiksilver, O'Neill). A flexibility is reduced, as Saoloto does not give up on "first category" quality to maintain its positioning premium.

●■ Coffee shop and RV Park: Power is low. The high supply of consumable suppliers and the volume of products allow for a greater room for maneuver in negotiating prices and terms.

Finally, although accommodation is not a direct product, partnerships strategies with local units create a relationship of mutual help. A Saoloto generates demand for the surrounding accommodation and, in return, benefits from a support network that makes the stay of your target audience easier.

4. Power

negotiation of

customers

Moderate/ High

Price sensitivity on the part of the customer (especially the international), along with the options of choice, enabled by the easy

access to information (strong digital presence in many brands, as already demonstrated) lead to increased negotiating power.

However, this power is mitigated at Saoloto due to the differentiation aesthetics, the philosophy inspired by Samoan culture and the range of products and services, which create a breaking point in direct comparison. When offering something unique, the brand reduces the customer's ability to negotiate only with based on market price.

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5. Threat of
products
substitutes
High

Although surfing offers a rare combination of adrenaline, together with the connection between nature and serenity, consumer habits change over time and, although there is still a desire to spend time in sea, the option may now fall on deep-sea fishing, or jet rides Ski.

Added to this, within the same segment of board activities, there are a series of alternatives that make surfing more of a choice. One Once again, this is another force that demonstrates the need for differentiation.

2.1.2.5 Competitive positioning matrix

In order to summarize the positioning that will be taken by the brand, it is presented below the matrix:

Image 9 - Competitive Positioning Matrix, 4th slide of the "Saoloto Data" portfolio

After analyzing the national and international market and competitive forces, it was possible to define the pillars that will support Saoloto Surf School's competitive advantage:



Quality as an Integrated Experience: Quality at Saoloto is not just a technical attribute of products and services, but the foundation of all relationships (customers, suppliers and partners). The brand assumes a human, authentic and organic, promoting communication that is a natural extension of the offline experience.

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Omnichannel: The brand's commitment lies in absolute coherence between the "vibe" felt on the sand and the narrative presented on digital platforms. This H2H (Human-to-Human) approach ensures that Saoloto is not only perceived as a service provider, but as a community of trust.



Pricing Strategy – Value vs. Accessibility: Regarding price, Saoloto adopts a Competitive Pricing Strategy, strategically positioning itself in the Upper-Middle segment.



Market Equilibrium: The objective is not to compete for the lowest price, nor isolate yourself in an inaccessible luxury segment. A value consistent with the superiority of the experience offered, allowing progressive and sustainable growth. This strategy makes it possible to capture the "exploring traveler" who values quality and exclusivity, but which seeks a fair relationship between the investment and the memory created. Although Saoloto is a new project entering a market with names already established, this should not be a premise that limits your ambition. With a strategy well-structured and focused on the niche of international explorers, the company's lack of history brand is compensated by the freshness of the value proposition and the specialization of the experience offered. Being a "new entrant" allows Saoloto not to be tied to business models obsolete, positioning itself from day one as the most authentic, modern alternative (to a certain extent) and market sustainable.

2.1.2.6 Trends

Although there is a critical position regarding the creation of content based on momentary trends, this analysis focuses on structural macro-trends that have shaped the sector in recent years and whose projections indicate its long-term continuity. The relevance of this section lies in the ability to provide Saoloto with resilience advance. By identifying the forces that are transforming consumer behavior and the surf market, the brand can proactively shape itself, ensuring that its value proposition remains relevant. More than following the moment, the objective is to align the brand with the future of the sector.

The critical trends are presented below, both positive and negative in nature. challenging, which will impact the brand's trajectory:

Trend

Impact & Justification

Positive: The equipment market (boards, suits, etc.) has presented a considerable growth and it is projected that grow at approximately 6.7% CAGR, until 2030.

Growth in equipment sales indicates that more people are starting or deepening the practice of surfing, which may lead one to believe that there will be a greater demand for classes, courses and surf camps, especially among beginners.

Negative: Increase in the average water level, between 4 and 5 millimeters per year, due to melting of ice caps.

Rising waters can cause waves to break closer of the sand, which can influence the movement patterns of same. This way, we can make a place like ours, which is extremely attractive, in a banal, unusable and inconsistent location. Another consequence will be the increase in water temperature, which This could lead to an interactive growth of algae. In turn, These can close the beach and prevent surfing.

Negative: The growth in the number of “players” in the “wave-pools” segment could become in 2028 a market for 3.8 billion.

Although they do not yet exist in Portugal, “wave-pools” are become a trend and pose a possible threat. In case of beginner surfers, can be more attractive, as they allow control the waves and offer more stable conditions for learning, unlike the sea, which is unpredictable and dangerous. Furthermore, if learning occurs in these spaces, it is likely that the rental or purchase of material also happens there, which can reduce revenue from this segment.

Positive: The generations of the future, Millennial

and Z, begin to give more importance to value of experiences and connections human rights, rather than the possession of material goods.

The Millennial and Z generations increasingly value experiences and human connections to the detriment of material goods. This trend is positive because surfing offers exactly this type of authentic and emotional experience. By positioning ourselves as a community and not just a school, we can create closer ties strong, generate loyalty and transform students into true ambassadors of the Saoloto experience.

2.1.3 Culture Analysis

Once the market structure was completed, where best practices were identified, the market gaps and saturated territories, the analysis now focuses on its central element: the Consumer. The relevance of deeply understanding the profile the brand is targeting

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it is absolute; a communication strategy that does not generate resonance with your target audience results in a drop in conversion, compromising sustainability and viability long-term financial aspect of the project.

In this section, it will be demonstrated that Saoloto's positioning and decisions

The strategies presented so far are not arbitrary. On the contrary, they are based on a solid foundation: the direct response to the needs, values and behaviors of the surfer.

Who consistently wakes up at 4.30am every morning and does the same thing year after year, decade after decade? The answer: monks and surfers.

Father Donald Calloway (Carter, n.d.)

As previously mentioned, even if subtly, the surfer's profile

Classic is defined by the incessant search for experiences. This individual understands the freedom and connection to the natural world as pillars of his existence, being driven by desire to explore the globe and establish connections with communities that share this same philosophy.

Some of the characteristics of this culture are (Carter, n.d.):



Freedom: The ultimate value that represents independence and possibility of an unrestricted existence, seeing the sea as a space for liberation from the pressures social.



Authenticity: The requirement to be true to yourself and others others, where surfing becomes a personal expression reflected in aesthetics, conduct and relationships.



Simplicity: The rejection of excess and materialism in favor of a balance centered on well-being and valuing the experience of the present.



Respect for Nature and Environmental Activism: An identity that faces the sea as a temple, requiring active protection and a deep ecological awareness.



Sustainability: The manifestation of conscious consumption that dictates the everyday choices, from selecting technical equipment to how you travel.



Spontaneity and Relaxation: A light and fluid attitude towards life,
which mirrors the unpredictability and dynamism of the ocean itself.

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Well-being (Balance and Well-being): The search for harmony between body and mind, often achieved through the fusion of surfing with complementary practices, like Yoga.



Sense of Community (Tribalism): The cultivation of bonds of companionship unbreakable, based on sharing a common passion that transcends barriers geographic or social.

This is clearly a culture where human branding is much more important than performance. There is a feeling of communion that the project aims to embrace, in sense in which, even these individuals who have been practicing for a long time are considered relevant, not for their money or services (such as instructors), but for the sake of turn Saoloto and its space into something unique, comfortable, authentic. In the long term, the The objective is to make the brand the “home of Portuguese surfing”, where regardless of the objective, whether it's learning or enjoying the coast, people can come and enjoy the space.

Another pertinent piece of information is the fact that this is a culture that comes from also the conscious challenge to the contemporary world. The resurgence of this style of Life at the end of the 20th century, as already mentioned, is a historical reaction to the work ethic rigid from the "Greatest Generation". This generation, shaped by the deprivations of the Great Wars and the Spanish Flu, focused on survival and extreme productivity (Carter, n.d.).

However, current generations, faced with the exhaustion of this model and the rise of Digital Nomadism, are now seeking to redefine work and leisure, where

The possibility of working close to the waves has become a new symbol of success. To Saoloto responds to this shift by offering a raw authenticity that rejects artificial perfection of social networks, focusing on real and lived experience (Carter, n.d.).

Finally, to reinforce this exposure, public opinion from Iguana Surf (April 2024):

“Have you ever thought about what makes surfing more than just a sport?

Than catching waves, surfing is also about the community that is created around it. It's changing stories on the beach after a great session, share tips and tricks, and support each other mutually while pushing our own limits.

One of the most special aspects of surfing is its ability to break down barriers that, from the outset, they would seem insurmountable. Culture, language, nationality or age — none of that matters when you're part of the surfing community.

When we talk about “surf culture”, this is what we are referring to: a community global, made up of people from all backgrounds and walks of life, united by the love of glide over the waves.

Surfing brings people together like few other things can.” (Iguana Surf, 2024).

In conclusion, surf culture reveals that the ocean is the great uniting element of the global community. Unlike other modalities that assume characteristics different cultures depending on geography, such as football, whose experience and rituals vary significantly between countries like Portugal and England for example, surfing maintains a universal and cohesive essence. The sea is one and interconnected, and this geographic fluidity is reflected in a culture whose identity traits are immediately recognized among their peers, regardless of each person's individual path.

In this way, Saoloto's purpose in Costa da Caparica transcends the operation local: the brand sees itself as a portal to this global culture. The objective is to create an ecosystem that breathes this universality, welcoming all those who experience surfing through its spiritual and community essence, ensuring that, at Saoloto, any surfer feels at home, united by the same ocean that bathes every other coast in the world.

2.1.4 Consumer Analysis

Finally, with an importance equal to or even greater than the other categories, at this point, the consumer analysis itself is presented. As already mentioned previously, a detailed understanding of the target audience constitutes the decisive step towards validation of Saoloto's strategic positioning. After characterizing the surroundings competitiveness and the values that govern surf culture, it is imperative to identify the specific profiles that will support the business model.

Image 10 - Consumer Analysis - Sources, 5th slide, from the “Saoloto Data” portfolio

For Saoloto's strategic decisions to be effective, it is essential that the consumer analysis is based on real facts and behavior. Therefore, the construction of the personas and their journeys is not born from assumptions, but rather from a crossing of several sources of information that guarantee the credibility of this study:



Search in Specialized Sources: Articles and guides were analyzed international studies that detail the motivations of those who choose Portugal to surf. One A fundamental example was this Surfing Guide in Portugal from American Surf Magazine, which helped create the profile of the traveling surfer.



Social Listening: Direct observation was carried out on the company's social networks competition. Through comments, questions and interactions from users on these pages, it was possible to identify what these customers value, what challenges they face when looking for places or schools as well as practice, what they miss, among other characteristics, important for profiling.



Artificial Intelligence as a Support Tool: AI was used as a an initial guide to help structure paths and ideas. However, it is important to reinforce that nothing was left to chance; All information generated has been rigorously verified and researched to ensure their veracity and usefulness for the project.

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Therefore, the profiles that follow are the result of a well-founded analysis, which reinforces, once again, the justification of the positioning and communication that Saoloto will adopt.

2.1.4.1 Personas

2.1.4.1.1 Lukas Schneider

Image 11 - Lukas Schneider, persona, 6th slide of the "Saoloto Data" portfolio

Lukas Schneider is a 29-year-old German citizen, resident in Munich. Yours geographical location, marked by the absence of sea and a cold climate, serves as the main driver for your motivation to explore surfing destinations, a practice through which shows enough interest to experience it in different parts of the world.

Some of the opportunities (insights) for Saoloto in this segment of the public are:



The "Geographical Contrast": The fact of living in Munich (cold/city) makes Saoloto's promise of "freedom" much more powerful. Communication should focus on emotional relief that you feel when you are on a beach.



Immunity to Traditional Marketing: As a UX Designer, Lukas detects easily false promises. Saoloto earns it through "raw" and real content (videos without

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large editions, real testimonials), confirming what he read during his research (Reddit, for example).



Valuing Time: Lukas has a stable income, so he doesn't look for the "cheapest", but rather the one that guarantees you the best use of your time (less crowd in the water and more personalized attention).



The Language Barrier: The fear of feeling like an "outsider" is a real pain. A Saoloto must communicate in fluent and inclusive English from the first contact, to ensure that he feels part of the "tribe".

2.1.4.1.1.1 Lukas' Journey

Image 12 - Consumer Journey, Lukas, 7th slide of the "Saoloto Data" portfolio

Lukas' journey shows that his decision is based on a validation process continuous process that begins long before arriving at the beach.

From this analysis of the consumer journey, the following opportunities stand out strategies:



"DM" as a Conversion Channel: Lukas uses Instagram to take specific questions about schedules and levels before deciding. The speed and tone of the response Saoloto are critical to closing the sale.



“Anti-Tourist” Content: In the consideration phase, it looks for videos of other beginners to gauge real progression. Saoloto must show real classes and not just perfect promotional images.



Reducing Pre-Travel Anxiety: Lukas feels a mix of excitement and fear of choosing poorly. Clear instructions on “what to bring” and “how to get there” at the time of check-in purchase are fundamental to generating trust.



The Value of the After-Sales Instructor: The fact that he follows and keeps the The instructors' contact indicates that the human bond is what guarantees their return. Encouraging this personal connection is key to retention.

In this way, Lukas' behavioral and psychological analysis allows us to identify main inhibitors and motivators that influence the decision to choose Saoloto. This diagnostics provides valuable insights to validate or adjust the marketing strategy, making it more targeted to the real needs of the consumer.

However, it is essential to note that defining this persona is a process dynamic and continuous, which must be maintained after the school starts operating. Although the data presented are substantiated, should not be interpreted as absolute, but rather as a strategic basis that will be refined and validated through practical experience and direct contact with the daily life of Saoloto Surf School.

2.1.4.1.2 Duarte Pacheco

Image 13 - Duarte Pacheco, persona, 8th slide of the "Saoloto Data" portfolio

Duarte Pacheco, aged 13 and residing in Almada, personifies the young and regional audience that seeks in surfing not only technical improvement, but a community of belonging. A primary school student, Duarte values honesty, respect and connection to nature, driven by the desire to find a space where you can express your identity. Your choice of school is strongly conditioned by need for a relaxed and inclusive environment that offers support at different levels skill level and is geographically accessible via public transport. The study of this profile allows us to extract fundamental points for the brand's performance in the regional market, in the younger category:



Inclusivity as a pillar of teaching: Saoloto must position itself as a facilitator for beginners, using welcoming communication to dispel fears of hostile or "closed" environments.



Connectivity and accessibility: The feasibility of regular attendance Duarte is dependent on the logistical facility (access via bus) from Almada, a factor that must be considered in brand proximity communication, if it is not guaranteed, in the development of solutions that reinforce this accessibility.



Bet on dynamic video formats: As a frequent user of TikTok and YouTube, Duarte is attracted to high-energy content ("shredding") and behind-the-scenes moments that show the progression and day-to-day life of the "tribe".



Management of power of influence: Although Duarte is not responsible financial, its role as final decision-maker requires the brand to create desire in young people as transmits an image of professionalism and security to those in charge of education.

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2.1.4.1.2.1 Duarte's Journey

Image 14 - Consumer Journey, Duarte, 9th slide of the "Saoloto Data" portfolio

Duarte's journey is marked by a phase of visual discovery on platforms digital, where the consumption of content from competitions and surfing legends dictates the desire to integration. The decision process focuses on validating the openness of the community and ease of access, culminating in a strong influence on parents' purchasing decisions. From this analysis of the consumer journey, the following opportunities stand out strategies:



Validation through digital niches: Active presence in communities online can reinforce the brand as an aspirational reference for young audiences.



Clarifying school culture: Using social networks to demonstrating that the community is united ("close-knit") but open to new members helps to mitigate the main objection related to the fear of exclusion.



Retention and advocacy potential: By offering a space that follows the technical evolution of Duarte, Saoloto has the opportunity to retain him as a local ambassador who recommends the school to their school network.

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In this way, Saoloto also presents itself as a brand oriented towards future, where cultural preservation is assumed as a central mission. The main objective involves sharing with the community the “Samoan” culture that gave rise to this practice, making a commitment to transmit it to the youngest, those who have the power to keep this heritage alive for generations to come.

This positioning is based on the respect and responsibility that the brand has to the history of surfing, reinforcing the idea that Saoloto is much more than a simple school.

2.1.4.1.3 Kelly Moraes

Image 15 - Kelly Moraes, persona, 10th slide of the “Saoloto Data” portfolio

Kelly Moraes, 42 years old, resident in Florianópolis, Brazil, is the embodiment of the “strong and independent woman” who, after years dedicated to her career as a Senior Analyst of Marketing and family responsibilities, he is looking for a transformative solo experience. With a high annual income (€75,000), Kelly values trips that they grow rich without tiring, looking for a way in the ocean to unwind and recover their well-being. Their main motivations are kindness, respect and community, although feel insecure about your physical fitness and the fear of encountering environments that are too technical or focused only on young and festive audiences.

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Analysis of Kelly's needs and fears allows us to identify opportunities crucial for brand positioning:



Focus on Safety and Welfare: Saoloto must actively communicate which is a safe and welcoming place for women (or simply travelers) traveling alone, directly responding to one of this persona's main objections.



Combating Body Stigma: Through inclusive communication, brand must show that there is no standard "surfer body", dispelling the fear of trials and encouraging the participation of students of all ages and physical shapes.



Differentiation of the "Party Camp" Environment: It is essential to reinforce that the school offers a mature and peaceful environment, focused on enriching experience and not in youth entertainment, to attract profiles that escape competitive or noisy.



Valuing Professional Experience: As a senior professional, the Kelly expects high-quality service and instructors who give her confidence that she will be able to evolve, regardless of the time passed since your last experience at sea.

2.1.4.1.3.1 Kelly's Journey

Image 16 - Consumer Journey, Kelly, 11th slide of the "Saoloto Data" portfolio

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Kelly's journey is guided by a search for inspiration in content emotions of influencers and traveling mothers, culminating in a careful analysis of the suitability of the school for mature beginners.

From this analysis of the route, the following insights stand out:



Influencer Marketing with Purpose: Saoloto can benefit from partnerships with influencers who share experiences of solo travel and self-improvement, resonating with Kelly's desire for a "transformative and lighthearted" journey.



Transparency and Support in the Decision Process: Using Instagram to sending direct messages and answering technical questions suggests that the brand must be prepared to offer personalized service that guarantees a feeling of inclusion before even from the reservation.



Loyalty through Reunion: By providing an environment where Kelly is able to "displace" herself from her routine and feel part of a community, Saoloto it becomes a destination of choice for future wellness breaks.

In short, Kelly's profile shows that communication should not be limited to a certain standard of personal or body image. Although the culture of the sport is sometimes associated with specific physical stereotypes, Saoloto positions itself as a space for everyone, regardless of their self-image. Authenticity and inclusivity, As already mentioned, they are non-negotiable pillars that allow anyone to feel integrated, regardless of how close or far it is from the traditional imaginary of the surfer.

At the same time, security asserts itself as a transversal strategic factor.

As this is an operation that involves physical activities outside the establishment, this This point is addressed as a priority from the first contact. Like anxiety pre-trip identified in Lukas, or the concerns of Duarte's parents, these barriers recurring ones must be proactively eliminated. By addressing these issues clearly, the brand demonstrates that it deeply understands its customer and is prepared to support at all stages of the journey: pre-, during and post-contact with the school.

2.1.4.2 Touchpoints & Behavior

Image 17 - Touchpoints, 12th slide of the “Saoloto Data” portfolio

Mapping contact points is a fundamental step in

ensure the coherence of the consumer experience at all stages of their journey,

supporting an effective omnichannel strategy. Identifying these moments of

interaction allows Saoloto to manage public expectations in an integrated way, ensuring

that values are communicated fluidly between digital and physical channels. Ao

controlling these points, the brand can eliminate potential friction and anticipate solutions

to the specific needs of each persona, transforming the initial contact into a

relationship of trust and, later, of loyalty.

According to the contact points shown in the previous image, the

following insights:



The Website as the Central Axis: The website is the most

transversal, acting at almost all stages, from awareness to retention.

Functions as the "anchor" of brand authority, where detailed information and the process

booking process (checkout) consolidate and facilitate, respectively, the purchasing decision.



The Credibility of Social Proof: The weight attributed to Word of Mouth and

opinions of other consumers is decisive, especially in the advocacy phase. In context

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of surfing, organic recommendation and validation by third parties convey a truth authenticity that direct advertising will not always be able to achieve.



Transition to Personalized Contact: It is observed that, in the consideration, the consumer favors direct communication channels, such as email or phone. This transition is crucial to dispel logistical, technical or insecurities, being facilitated through more human and close service.



Effectiveness in Capturing Intent: Using Google Search Ads in the decision-making process allows the brand to be the immediate answer for users with high intention to purchase, ensuring visibility at the exact moment when the need for a school surfing is manifested.



Post-Experience Loyalty Cycle: The retention strategy, supported by satisfaction surveys and newsletters, demonstrates that the relationship with the customer does not end at the surf lesson. This continuous monitoring aims to prolong the emotional bond with the school, encouraging the return and transformation of the student into a brand ambassador.

In summary, the analysis carried out reinforced the initial assumptions of the project and allowed the discovery of fundamental insights about the market and target audience. This data will serve basis for brand development and a strategy with a strong foundation theoretical and practical. Although it is recognized that the data are not absolute and that their effectiveness full can only be assured through actual operation, the line of thought covered demonstrates that Saoloto has a solid and viable structure to progress.

Once this stage is complete, the phase of creating and defining Saoloto's identity begins Surf School. Based on the insights obtained from market and target audience analysis, this moment of the project focuses on the strategic translation of these conclusions into an identity of a coherent, distinctive and operable brand. For this purpose, the central brand guidelines, such as the Marketing Mix and Moodboard, among other elements structures, which will allow the outlined strategic vision to be shaped.

These guidelines will form Saoloto's "Bible", an essential document for new collaborators or future partnerships with communication agencies and influencers. This will be the document that guarantees that the essence, values and image of the brand are replicated in coherent and faithful way on any platform or context.

2.2 Brand Guidelines

This chapter presents Saoloto to the reader through a strategic itinerary that starts from the emotional and conceptual dimension of the brand and evolves into its tangible and corporate. It starts by defining emotional identity, exploring what the brand intends to represent and awaken its consumers, and continues to organize physical and operational elements that support this identity.

In this way, brand architecture is built from its essence and purpose inspirational, culminating in the definition of image, communication and logistics guidelines. This path ensures that each visual or operational decision is aligned with the values of the school, ensuring coherence and consolidating Saoloto as an authentic and close to your audience.

2.2.1 Conceptual Identity

2.2.1.1 Saoloto's Purpose

"We believe that it is possible to find peace in the midst of the rush."

This purpose constitutes the core identity of Saoloto and reflects the commitment to transform surfing into an experience of balance and deep belonging. The brand assumes itself as the "Portuguese surfing house", a welcoming space that functions as a refuge of serenity in the face of the acceleration of urban daily life, but which is, above all, a meeting point of cultures.

The foundation of this vision is the creation of an inclusive and global ecosystem, where Portuguese hospitality merges with Samoan heritage. By uniting individuals from all over the world, from the amateur looking for their first connection with the sea (like Kelly, or the Duarte) to the experienced surfer who seeks the technical and spiritual essence of the sport (as Lukas), Saoloto proves that the sea is a space for communion.

2.2.1.2 Golden circle

To translate this vision into concrete strategic elements, Golden Circle. Theorized by Simon Sinek, this is a strategic model that organizes identity of the brand on three concentric levels: Why, How and What. This methodology argues that communication must be done from the "inside out", starting

by the deepest motivation and purpose of the organization, and only then detail the processes and services that it makes available to society (Sinek, 2026).

For Saoloto Surf School (SSS), the Golden Circle is organized as follows (13th slide from the “Saoloto Data” portfolio):



Why: To provide children and adults, for beginners and veterans, a feeling/experience of freedom and contact/union with nature close in what is the busiest area in the country.



How: Through a multidisciplinary approach that allows conciliate the teaching of basics to beginners and the consolidation of knowledge for more advanced teams, to ensure that no one is left out. Also fostering a feeling of camaraderie that allows an exchange of knowledge and stories from which everyone leaves benefited.



What (What?):

■ Surf lessons from 8 to 80, in groups and solo, in class packages or singular classes;

■ Adapted surfing lessons;

■ Surf Camp

■ Rental of material;

■ Instructor and resuscitation certification;

■ Physical Spaces: RV park, Cafeteria/"Hangout Spot".

2.2.1.3 Value Proposition

Based on the purpose, approach and offering defined by Golden Circle, the Saoloto structures its value proposition in a way that goes beyond simply teaching surfing, offering an experience of transformation and refuge. This proposal is divided into three fundamental pillars:

1.

Reconnection and Well-Being (The Pause): The promise of finding peace and balance in a fast-paced daily life, using surfing as a tool for mindfulness and urban disconnection.

2.

Community and Belonging (The House): The guarantee of integration into a "house of

surfing" inclusive, where human branding eliminates barriers to performance, allowing amateurs and experts share the same space authentically.

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3.

Strategic Convenience (The Location): The ease of accessing a experience of freedom and wild nature just minutes from the center of Lisbon.

In short, Saoloto's Unique Selling Point (USP) is:

More than learning to surf, it's living in a community without borders where the sea unites people, cultures and moments in a free and authentic spirit.

2.2.2 Positioning and Differentiation

Continuing the path of building Saoloto's guidelines, this

The chapter now focuses on its strategic positioning. This concept refers to the form how the brand approaches the market at the consumer level, shaping their perception of the company compared to the existing offer.

2.2.2.1. STP (Segmentation, Targeting and Positioning)

To organize and display this information, the STP model was selected (Segmentation, Targeting and Positioning). This model allows you to segment the audience, identify the priority target of action and define the position that the brand will occupy in the imagination of consumers, unequivocally distinguishing itself from the rest of the competition.

Step

Answer

S - Segmentation

- Surf enthusiasts.
- Schools/ATLs/Holiday Camps (Summer Vacations).
- Beginner Practitioners.
- Veteran/Experienced Practitioners.
- Professionals.
- Outdoor enthusiasts.

T - Target audience

Enthusiasts and beginner surfers, aged 8 to 50, with little or no experience looking to experience a little this way of life, while developing their skills.

P - Positioning

We want to develop a community and leave a legacy, at the same time time that we reinforce our authenticity and reduce the barrier inherent to this type of sport.

The positioning adopted for basic communication is based on the nature of the

Saoloto as a new entrant on the market. Like any project in the launch phase,

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there is a critical need to ensure the survival of the business and the generation of profit, which requires a focus on the segment of inexperienced practitioners.

This is the public that most actively seeks teaching and rental services made available by the school, communication is aimed primarily at this group, as this aims at the sales volume necessary for immediate operational viability. However, this positioning does not neglect the brand's identity vision, worked until here. It is extremely important that one of the main objectives continues to be to achieve the experienced surfers since they have the authority and credibility necessary to validate Saoloto organically and through earned media.

In this way, while service communication is designed to attract those who wants to learn, the "community and legacy" positioning aims to build notoriety together for those who are just looking for an authentic space to hang out and surf. This duality ensures that amateurs sustain the business, while veterans consolidate the soul and brand prestige.

So that this duality is translated consistently at each point of contact with the public, it is essential to define a tone of voice that reflects the brand's identity and humanize communication.

2.2.2.2 Tone of Voice

Defining a specific tone of voice plays a central role in consolidating of the SSS identity, working in close coordination with the moodboard (presented in the point 2.2.4.2). More than an element of communication, the tone of voice personifies the brand, ensuring that all interactions, written or verbal, reinforce coherence between the visual communication and the values of authenticity and human proximity.

By providing the project with its own language, an emotional connection is established more consistent with the public, converting the provision of a service into a relationship of trust and cultural sharing.

Its development was guided by a balance between technical professionalism and the relaxation associated with the surfing lifestyle, allowing the brand to be positioned as an accessible, safe and experienced authority, capable of communicating clearly and directly to its availability to welcome anyone looking for a genuine experience.

Thus, the tone of voice below is presented:

The Mentor of the Seas / The Sage of Shorebreak (The Voice of the School)

Authentic and Timeless

- Voice of "Kupuna" (Elder): shares the essence and purpose ("why does the sea give us calls").

- Uses "we" to evoke a lineage and "you" to create a direct and paternal ("We believe...", "On your path...").

Serene and Majestic

- Recognizes the grandeur of the ocean and the surfer's humility before nature.

- Merges the celebration of the student's evolution with respect for the lessons of the sea ("Your first wave was a triumph, but it's when you fall that the sea teaches you how to get up").

Visionary and Respectful of Legacy

- Talks about the future of surfing with a look rooted in the beginnings and genesis Polynesian.

- Poetic language, but with a technical clarity that inspires confidence and security.

Accessible and Engaging

- Invites introspection and sharing: "Tell us, what did you feel on the horizon?" or "Share with us your first breath of salt".

- Short, genuine and in-depth responses that demonstrate availability (while maintaining always a 'premium' and elevated tone).

Subtly Initiatory

- Shares behind-the-scenes glimpses: the ritual of choosing your board, reading the wind at dawn, "silent knowledge".

- Uses anticipations that arouse curiosity ("Soon, we'll share the secret of that tide..." or "Get ready to see the sea like you've never seen it...").

Pillars of Tone of Voice

1. The Guardian of the Essence

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- Acts as a bridge between Polynesian kings and the modern student.
- Uses storytelling to educate: "Long before we were here, the sea was already setting the pace. We just learn to listen to it."

2. Calm Authority

- You don't need to shout to be heard. The tone is slow, like the crashing of waves.
- Avoid "aggressive marketing" terms. Instead of "Buy now", use "The sea awaits for you" or "Enter the circle".

3. Lexical Depth (The "Genesis")

- Rich and classic vocabulary, without being arrogant.
- Words of choice: Core, Design, Tune, Lineage, Plenitude.

4. Interactive Wisdom

- Responds with the weight of experience: "Each wave is a conversation. What did you learn in yours?"
- Maintains the posture of someone who has seen a thousand tides, but is still moved by the first foam from a student.

2.2.2.3 Partnerships

Finally, due to the interesting and important opportunity it represents, it is important consider the role of partnerships as an instrument to reinforce the positioning of the brand.

This point aims to demonstrate that the defined positioning can be consolidated through the establishment of partnerships with brands, projects and platforms that present strategic coherence, both in terms of brand values and identity, and in terms of expectations, interests and behaviors of the target audience. Thus, partnerships are assumed as a differentiating element, capable of enhancing the value proposition and expanding the reach of the brand in an organic and credible way.

Types of Potential Partnerships

The identified partnerships can be organized into different categories, depending on according to its nature and strategic contribution:

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Brands

Partnerships with brands such as Indiecampers, Cerveja Nortada, clothing brands 100% Portuguese and thehandmade.porto allow you to establish a direct connection to universes associated with lifestyle, mobility, authenticity and the appreciation of the national product. These associations reinforce the brand's positioning as a promoter of experiences aligned with a contemporary, sustainable culture and local identity.

Blogs and Digital Media

Collaboration with specialized editorial platforms such as Surfd.com and Surfer.com, provides access to highly qualified audiences who are already aware of the surfing universe. These partnerships contribute to the brand's credibility, at the same time that increase their notoriety among audiences that value specialized content and reference.

Projects

Partnerships with projects such as Norteturfer.pt and no_signal_events allow for a approach to specific communities and initiatives that promote experiences, events and lifestyles aligned with the brand's values. This type of collaboration reinforces the experiential dimension of positioning and favors the creation of emotional connections with the public.

Search and Discovery Platforms

The presence on platforms such as Goboony and Yeeew.com enhances the visibility of brand in active search contexts, where users look for experiences, accommodation or activities aligned with your interests. These partnerships function as strategic touchpoints throughout the consumer journey.

From these partnerships, the central objective is to build notoriety mutual, based on the understanding that the target audience operates transversally between different brands, platforms and experiences. By recognizing this interconnection, brands partners demonstrate an in-depth reading of their audience, being able to offer experiences that are consistent, relevant and aligned with your preferences and values.

Consequently, partnerships contribute not only to strengthening the positioning and differentiation of the brand, as well as creating a proposal more robust, integrated and sustainable value model in the medium and long term.

2.2.3 Marketing Mix - 7Ps

This framework aims to transpose Saoloto's theoretical positioning into a plan of practical actions, segmenting them through the different dimensions of a organization that interacts, in this case, directly with the end consumer. The option for application of the 7P's model, instead of the traditional 4P's (Product, Price, Place and Promotion), is justified by the nature of the business: the provision of services. This Thus, the three added vectors that guarantee the quality and coherence of delivery are:

- People: It is essential to align all employees who communicate on behalf of the brand. Although human interaction contains a subjectivity intrinsically, common bases must be established that ensure a cohesive discourse faithful to the project identity.

- Processes: The mapping of internal dynamics allows the school operates in an organized and fluid manner. From the first contact to conversion Ultimately, processes ensure that the customer experience is consistent and efficient.

- Physical Evidence: This category focuses on the elements tangibles that attest to the quality of the service. These are the visual confirmation points and information that allows the consumer to validate the school's authority at any stage of the your journey.

It should be noted that, similar to the creation of personas, these rules must and can be adjusted according to Saoloto's operational reality. Considering that the dynamics of market and consumer preferences are volatile, this model constitutes a point of starting point is based and strategic, but not absolute, and must evolve depending on practice and real feedback.

The detailed structure of the proposed Marketing Mix is presented below:

P

Question

Answer

Product

(Product)

What does the brand offer?

What need does it solve?

●■ Surfing Lessons:

■ ■ In groups and solo;

●■ Class packages or single classes;

●■ Adapted surfing lessons;

●■ Material rental;

●■ Instructor certification;

●■ First Aid Certification.

●■ Surf Camp:

■ ■ RV park;

■ ■ Cafeteria;

■ ■ "Hangout Spot"/Community.

Price

(Price)

What is the strategy

price and perceived value?

●■ "Competitive pricing": Strategy that requires analysis about direct competition in order to be able to infer which the price most adjusted to the market and what the consumer are you willing to spend for an experience like this.

Place

(Square)

Where and how does the customer have access to the product?

●■ To buy:

■ ■ Online via the Website.

■ ■ Offline in the physical space of Saoloto Surf School.

●■ To enjoy:

■ ■ In the physical space of Saoloto Surf School.

Promotion

(Promotion)

How the brand communicates and
attracts the public?

●■ Social Networks:

■ ■ Instagram;

■ ■ Facebook;

■ ■ Weibo;

■ ■ Reddit;

■ ■ Youtube.

●■ Own website.

●■ Presence in Directories.

●■ Partnership with Influencers.

●■ Online Advertising:

■ ■ Search (Google);

■ Display (Google).

●■ “AMA Strategy”:

■ ■ Events/Lectures.

■ ■ CBM - Community-Based Marketing (Reddit by
example).

●■ **SEO.**

●■ Offline marketing: Flyers and posters.

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People

(People)

Who represents the brand

(team, service,
community)?

- Founders.

- Influencers and guest hosts/"experts": Individuals who do part of the communication + personalities of the community/market.

- "The family" (clients).

- Teams: Marketing (CRM operations) + Instructors + "Customer Service" (who works in the cafeteria and reception).

Process

(Process)

How is it delivered to
experience?

- Integration of a "unified" model: Uniting what the customer information and conversions obtained digitally to offline processes.

- Communication is done omni-channel, in order to always keep the essence/image of the brand present (Unique branding).

physics

Evidence

(Physical evidence)

What signs prove the
quality of experience?

- Online:

- ■ "Social Proof" (As soon as possible);

- ■ Online Community (engagement metrics).

- Offline:

- ■ Traffic in the physical space (active customers + customers post experience);

●■ “Word of mouth”.

2.2.4 Narrative and Visual Expression

To consolidate the set of guidelines that define the identity and way of operate from Saoloto Surf School, this last point is dedicated to the way the brand expresses itself and communicates within its ecosystem. After defining the emotional structure and operational, it becomes imperative to materialize the essence of the brand through a narrative and of an aesthetic that translates, in a unique way, the relationship between Samoan cultural heritage and the offering of school services and products.

The construction of this chapter is based on three fundamental models. Firstly, the strategic narrative is established, focused on articulating Samoan surf culture with the practical usefulness of classes and physical space. Secondly, the visual expression is defined, selecting the elements that best project the authenticity of the culture and the atmosphere of the Saoloto's “urban refuge”. Finally, all this content production is structured under the AIDA model (Attention, Interest, Desire and Action), ensuring that communication is not just aesthetics, but rather an effective vehicle to guide the consumer through all the stages of your decision journey.

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2.2.4.1 Storytelling and Message

Saoloto's narrative is not a mere description of services, but a construction myth that gives a deep purpose to the consumer experience. Storytelling works as the common thread that connects Samoan ancestral heritage to the contemporary context of surfing in Portugal, allowing the public to see themselves on a journey of personal and collective. By adopting the motto "Where the Waves Sculpt Family", the brand assumes the responsibility to tell a story that challenges the conventional and individualistic view of sport, proposing the following narrative arc:

Saoloto: The Strength of the Tribe at Sea



Common World: Contemporary surfing has become a sport of isolation. Schools focus on individual performance, on the technique of "me" against the wave. The image is sold of the lonely, disconnected surfer, who sees the ocean only as a stage for your ego and personal achievement. It is unknown that, in Samoan origins, surfing it was never a solo act, but an extension of the tribe's life.



Problem: This purely technical and individualistic vision creates a rupture dangerous. When we separate the surfer from his environment and peers, we lose the essence spirituality of practice. We forget that treating the ocean as an object separates us from nature, and treating surfing as an isolated achievement separates us from humanity. Without the connection to the whole, the technique is empty and the surfer remains incomplete.



Solution: Saoloto Surf School recovers the ancestral perspective: we don't surf in the ocean, you surf with him and with others. Our pedagogy goes beyond maneuvering; we build an experience where the student learns to breathe in unison with the tide and the group. We teach that the wave does not belong to anyone, it is shared, just like the energy that moves us.



Transformation: We restore the lost link between man, the gods and the group. The big lesson is the Samoan paradox: only when someone truly becomes part of a community is that it can rise up as an individual. At Saoloto, you are no longer a solitary visitor at sea to become part of a living ecosystem, finding your identity through belonging.

2.2.4.1.1 History of a Customer

In order to demonstrate how this storytelling can resonate with the target audience, it is

Below is a fictitious example of a customer testimonial:

"The film promised me a family, Saoloto gave me one."



Before: It all started when I saw the movie "Surf's Up". I didn't just want catching waves, I wanted to experience that connection I saw between penguins, that feeling of tribe and respect for the sea. I immediately enrolled in a local school, full of expectations, looking for my own version of that relaxed, close-knit community.



Conflict: The reality was a shock. The schools I went to were cold and focused only on individual performance. It was all about who could get to their feet the fastest or who had the best equipment. I was surrounded by people at sea, but I felt completely alone. The technique was there, but the soul was missing. I was almost giving up, I thought that "vibe" of family and spiritual connection was just Hollywood fiction.



After: It was then that I discovered Saoloto Surf School. As soon as I entered water with them, I felt: this was it! They didn't just teach surfing, they taught the philosophy of early Samoans. For the first time, it wasn't me against the wave, or me against the others students. We were a community, surfing with the ocean and with each other. At Saoloto, I finally found the family that the film promised me. I stopped being an individual trying prove something to be part of a community.

This narrative constitutes Saoloto's central argument, elevating the brand's status as a seller of products and services to that of "guardian" of a culture. When anchoring communication in this arc of transformation, the school guarantees that the promise of "sculpting family" is perceived as authentic, serving as a basis for visual expression and effectiveness of the following conversion model.

2.2.4.2 Moodboard

The Saoloto Surf School Moodboard is not just an aesthetic collection, but the visual materialization of the strategic narrative: "Where the Waves Sculpt Family".

This composition graphically translates the fusion between the spiritual heritage of the culture Samoan, represented by wisdom in the figure of "Kupuna" and in the ancestral celebration, and the

raw authenticity of Costa da Caparica, symbolized by the traditional boats local fishing.

The chromatic palette, dominated by the deep blues of the ocean and the greens of the tropical vegetation, was selected to evoke the “natural refuge” we promise our urban consumer. Prioritizing images of collective conviviality, genuine smiles and group exploration (like the concept of 'roadtrip'), the visual identity rejects the coldness of individualistic technical performance to embrace the warmth of human connection, ensuring that the brand communication conveys, at first glance, the values of freedom, inclusion and belonging that define Saoloto.

Image 18 - Conceptual Moodboard: The visual intersection between the Polynesian soul and the Portuguese experience

2.2.4.3 AIDA Model

With the strategic narrative visually materialized through the Moodboard, It becomes possible to structure communication in a way that effectively guides the customer experience. customer. To do this, the AIDA Model (Attention, Interest, Desire and Action) is used.

This model is used to structure the fundamental points of the customer journey, from the first contact (cold audience) to the final decision-making (warm audience).

Although this is usually a framework applied to the creation of specific content to ensure that they have a narrative with a beginning, middle and end, in the context of this

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project the model was developed for the brand globally. Thus, the points presented below serve as strategic guidelines that should guide the creation of more specific and segmented content.

Below, the application of the AIDA Model for SSS:

Image 19 - AIDA model, 14th slide of the “Saoloto Data” portfolio

In short, the definition of Saoloto's identity base has been completed. This chapter covered the entire spectrum of the brand, from its emotional and spiritual genesis to its physical and operational guidelines, serving as the master guide for any individual or entity that intends to collaborate with the project.

The guidelines established here must be applied transversally throughout the school ecosystem: from meetings and presentations (talks) to copywriting and visual expression of content. The aim is to ensure that Saoloto operates under a omnichannel and “unified” model, where the consumer experience is fluid, coherent and integrated, regardless of the point of contact.

This consistency is what allows you to build a strong and safe. By ensuring that each interaction reflects the same values and narrative, the project achieves what the group always wanted: to transform a beta and simple project into a trusted brand, capable of creating a real and lasting impact on the surfing community.

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2.3 Strategy

Once Saoloto's identity and guidelines have been consolidated, the focus now shifts for tactical operationalization: the creation of the Go-to-Market (GTM) strategy. Given that the conceptual foundations and brand essence were justified in detail in the previous chapters, this section takes on a more pragmatic and objective character, focusing on execution and making results tangible.

The GTM strategy is articulated through four logical pillars:

- Campaign Base: Where the objectives to be achieved are established, ensuring that these are realistic and measurable through concrete metrics.
- Brand Ecosystem: Mapping communication channels and the way how the school will interact with its target audience throughout the journey.
- Content Pillars and Examples: The organization of message types which will flesh out the narrative, accompanied by practical examples of application.
- Operationalization and Feasibility: The technical and bureaucratic component of the project, which although it can only be justified with the reality experienced by it, will be presented as a prediction of what may be problems or tests that will be performed.

With this approach, all points of the strategy will be addressed, demonstrating the group's ability to develop a 360° marketing strategy. Despite the focus significant in the emotional and rational dimensions underlying the brand, it is evident also the ability to integrate a performance logic, thus ensuring effective marketing of the products and services that Saoloto proposes to offer the customer.

2.3.1 Definition of Success

2.3.1.1 SMART objectives, metrics, KPIs and success

As previously mentioned, the objectives function as the strategic guide of any marketing plan, transforming the brand's vision into concrete goals and measurable. So that the team, both in the construction of content and in the execution of tactical actions, stay focused on the commercial purpose and do not get distracted by impulses creative without foundation, these objectives establish a rigorous path to follow.

To ensure the effectiveness of this monitoring, the SMART methodology is used (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound), which ensures that each objective is specific, measurable, attainable, relevant and time-bound.

2.3.1.1.1 Objective Awareness

Reach 25,000 followers on the Instagram page by the time it is 1 year old.

This objective is justified by the fact that the number of followers is assumed to be a pillar of social proof and authority. As Saoloto is a new entrant in the market, The size of your digital community serves as an indicator of trust for the public inexperienced.

More than vanity, this metric is strategic for two reasons:

1.

Validation of Community Positioning: For a brand that positions itself as a "family", Instagram functions as the digital showcase of this union. O number of followers reflects the scale of the "tribe" that Saoloto is building.

2.

Negotiation Power (Borrowed Media): A profile with this volume of followers increases the brand's attractiveness for partnerships with influencers and others local entities, facilitating the expansion of notoriety through third-party channels. Then, in order to measure the success of actions aimed at achieving this objective, the primary and secondary KPIs are presented as well as the form, the range and measurement tool, and also the aforementioned target:

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Image 20 - Measurement Framework, Awareness, 15th slide of the “Saoloto Data” portfolio

2.3.1.1.2 Objective Consideration

Collect 750 contacts (follower -> Lead) on our website during the first six months.

The collection of 750 contacts is important as it allows the validation of customer segments audience initially identified, comparing the theoretical personas with the real profile of the interested in SSS. This database works as a foundation for optimizing paid traffic campaigns (Google and Meta Ads), as it allows you to structure target audiences more precisely and reduce wasted investment in segments that do not convert.

In short, this metric transforms abstract knowledge about the customer into data actionable, demonstrating the brand's adherence to the market and allowing agile adjustment of the communication strategy given the reality observed during the first six months.

Below, the KPIs, similar to the previous objective:

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Image 21 - Measurement Framework, Consideration, 16th slide of the “Saoloto Data” portfolio

2.3.1.1.3 Conversion Objective

Guarantee “Full occupancy” up to one month before the start of our first Surf Camp (50 students).

Ensuring maximum capacity for the first Surf Camp one month before it takes place is a critical goal for the financial validation of the project, allowing to confirm whether the cost estimates and planned profit margins are viable given the actual acceptance of the market.

The early exhaustion of 50 places serves as the ultimate test of product-market fit. Bearing in mind that the first surf camp will have a price calculated by estimate, ensuring full capacity allows you to validate whether the pricing policy reflects the value real perceived by the community, providing the necessary operational stability before from the start of the event. Otherwise, the necessary changes will be implemented, so to optimize results in the following period.

Then, maintaining the same structure, the KPIs:

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Image 22 - Measurement Framework, Conversion, 17th slide of the “Saoloto Data” portfolio

2.3.1.1.4 Retention Objective

“Fill” the second surf camp with at least 25% repeat participants.

Achieving a 25% recidivism rate at the second Surf Camp constitutes the main indicator of quality and brand loyalty, validating the effectiveness of the experience Saoloto on the ground. This retention objective is essential to prove that the promise emotional sense of belonging and “family” is effectively materialized, transforming students punctual contacts with active members of the community.

More than a volume metric, the guarantee that a quarter of participants chooses to return demonstrates the robustness of the value delivered, allowing to reduce costs of long-term customer acquisition (CAC) and consolidate an ambassador base organic products that will support the school's future growth.

Below, the KPIs relating to the objective:

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Image 23 - Measurement Framework, Retention, 18th slide of the “Saoloto Data” portfolio

2.3.1.1.5 Advocacy Objective

Collect 500 posts from members who “tag” SSS by June 30th.

The goal of garnering organic posts generated by members (User-Generated Content - UGC) is assumed to be the maximum indicator of the vitality of the community and the effectiveness of the brand's Ethos on the ground. This social listening metric goes beyond mere digital visibility, functioning as authentic social proof of the quality of experience and the human environment that the school aims to create.

By encouraging spontaneous sharing, Saoloto validates that its “family” narrative was effectively internalized by the students, transforming them into active “defenders” of the brand; conversely, a low performance on this objective would signal a failure in the delivery of the emotional value proposition, serving as a critical alert to the need to readjust the school's culture and operational experience.

Once again below, the KPIs of the aforementioned objective:

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Image 24 - Measurement Framework, Advocacy, 19th slide of the “Saoloto Data” portfolio

2.3.2 Ecosystems and Environments

With the strategic objectives defined, it becomes necessary to operationalize them. For this effect, it is important to return to the analyzes developed throughout the project: the analysis of market, which highlighted the growth of the Chinese market; the analysis of the target audience, which allowed the identification of the platforms used and their respective purposes of use; and the development of the Marketing Mix, in which the “Promotion” element synthesizes the marketing channels Saoloto communication.

Based on these three axes, which reinforced each other throughout the project, it is presented the brand's marketing ecosystem. This was built following the model POEM (Paid, Owned, Earned Media), distributed strategically throughout the phases of the sales funnel (TOFU, MOFU and BOFU), ensuring that each platform meets a specific role in the customer conversion journey.

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Image 25 - Saoloto Ecosystem, 20th slide of the "Saoloto Data" portfolio

The articulation between the different phases of the ecosystem allows Saoloto to implement a 360° strategy, where identity coherence is maintained at all points of contact.

This structure provides a clear view of the role of each type of media in the conversion process:



Owned Media: Serve as the foundation of trust and the center of the narrative of the brand. Through the Website, Instagram and Newsletter, Saoloto has full control over the message, promoting the continuous reinforcement of identity and the deepening of the relationship with the "family".



Earned Media: They represent the most valuable asset for the credibility of the company school. The focus on UGC (User-Generated Content) and organic testimonials on Reddit or TikTok turns students into ambassadors by providing the social proof needed to validate the brand's Ethos before new interested parties.



Paid Media: Act as the strategic accelerator of the funnel. While in TOFU (Awareness) ads in Meta and TikTok Ads guarantee reach and discovery, in BOFU (Conversion) SEM and Retargeting ensure that purchase intent is capitalized efficiently.

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In short, this organization guarantees that Saoloto is not limited to "being present" in platforms, but that uses them tactically. By aligning formats and objectives with the internship of consumer maturity, from the first visual impact to the final reservation, the brand builds a safe, fluid and, above all, human route.

It is important to note that, although email marketing is not activated in the initial phase of entry into the market, its inclusion in the ecosystem reflects the recognition of its importance as a strategic tool for capturing leads. This option demonstrates that the group understands its role in the development and maturation of the business and that, if proves relevant at a later stage, you will know how to integrate it appropriately into the company's strategy. Saoloto.

2.3.2.1 Platforms

So that the 360° strategy is not just a concept, it is essential to define the operational role of each channel within the POEM ecosystem. If the previous diagram mapped the customer journey through the funnel, the following table details the strategic justification, targets and resources needed for each platform.

Image 26 - Platforms (Social Networks), 21st slide of the "Saoloto Data" portfolio

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In this way, the tactical justification for the use of each platform, clarifying the individual role of each channel and the critical resources required for your operational success.

2.3.2.2 SEO

This is a tactic that, despite taking time to generate results, has a high potential to increase brand awareness and, consequently, its credibility and authority over the search terms used, as long as it is conducted with strategic vision and actions aligned with the objectives set.

To illustrate how to perform a proper analysis of the most relevant keywords, this topic demonstrates the process of identifying and selecting terms, as well as how the website could be further optimized to maximize its performance.

In the case of a surf school located in Costa da Caparica, Portugal, there are various approaches and sources for keyword analysis, including Google Trends, Semrush, Ubersuggest, People Also Ask, AnswerThePublic, among others. For this project, we chose to use Google Ads, analyzing the Gecko School website, which, according to the school, presents 1,051 opinions in the SERP associated with the search for your name, with a classification average of 5 stars.

In Google Ads, following the path Tools > Planning > Marketing Planner Keyword, you can access the “Discover new keywords” tool, which allows you to identify different search terms associated with a particular website or keyword.

Applying this tool to the Gecko website, the following results are obtained:

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Image 27 - Result of keywords searching the Gecko website

Given these results, it was possible to extract some insights into the following keywords:

Keyword

Importance

Role in Strategy

Lisbon Surf Camp

High volume (1 thousand to 10

thousand) with low competition.

Although this keyword is not targeted by consumer experience, indicates high demand for this type of service, combined with competition downtown, an ideal opportunity for Saoloto to highlight the Surf Camp on the market. Being in English demonstrates that the research comes from an international audience, situation that aligns with the project.

Surf Camp

Features a volume

high (1 thousand to 10 thousand) with

low competition.

Although it is a broad keyword, as it does not is associated with a specific location and the intention research is not entirely clear, its low competition represents a strategic opportunity for Saoloto to explore and position itself with authority to anyone using this search term.

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Surf Lessons

Caparica

Volume from 100 to 1 thousand and average competition.

It is the direct conversion term par excellence. Reflects the user who has already decided on the location (Caparica) and service (classes). It is the keyword that best responds to the educational and commercial pillar of the school.

Costa da Caparica

Surfing

Volume from 100 to 1 thousand and average competition.

Fundamental for local SEO. Ensures that the brand is associated with the geographic territory of operation, reinforcing its authority in its main region.

Surf Course

Portugal

Volume from 1 thousand to 10 thousand monthly surveys and a low competition.

Works at the top of the funnel to capture an international audience looking for structured training. The bid at the top of page (low range) of €0.53 makes it a term efficient way to generate authority at a controlled cost.

Thus, these keywords demonstrated that there is an opportunity for Saoloto to stand out in terms of Google searches. It is important to bear in mind that the competition considered in this analysis focuses on paid ads, which implies that these keywords must be researched organically and the results subsequently analyzed in a depth, allowing you to understand both the search intent underlying each term as the real value of the offer, given that demand corresponds to the volume of searches. In general, this investigation showed that there is room for evolution in what continues to be, even today, the largest population research network worldwide.

2.3.2.3 Influencer Marketing

Like other communication tactics aimed at building authority and notoriety, the integration of influencers can contribute to the acceleration of brand recognition among its target audience, shortening the time needed to achieve levels of visibility that would otherwise be achieved more gradually. Even so, influencer marketing has its own specificities, which is why It is important to analyze its potential benefits and risks in the context of Saoloto's strategy:

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Paid media: most campaigns with influencers involve direct investment (compensation, content production, paid amplification), so the Impact depends on the allocated budget and the quality of the activations.



Short-term: Collaborations tend to generate spikes in visibility and traffic immediate; Without integration into an ongoing strategy, these effects are typically transients.



Credibility: when there is genuine alignment between influencer and brand, and When disclosures are clear, perceptions of trust and authenticity can increase significantly; however, authenticity is volatile and can be questioned by public.



Ambassadors: transforming occasional employees into ambassadors brand (long-term partnerships) allows you to mitigate the transience of the impact and build stronger associations between brand and audience.



Tarnished image = lost notoriety: there is a reputational risk real: controversies, lack of transparency or incompatible influencer behaviors they can be transferred to the brand, causing a loss of trust and notoriety. For this For this reason, contractual clauses, prior due diligence and monitoring are recommended continuous.

Given this context, the analysis demonstrated the existence of different influencers who reveal complementary features to the project, two of which are presented below:

●■ Teresa Bonvalot

@teresabonvalot.

Followers: 71,421.

Engagement rate: 2.26%.

Based on the pillars of the Saoloto Surf School, Teresa Bonvalot is the ideal fit as it is a top Portuguese professional surfer (Olympic athlete and national champion), giving technical authority and credibility for the Surf [Technical] and Lifestyle & Performance pillars that interest our experienced audience (Lukas). On the other hand, its status as female reference directly inspires beginners and the Community and

Conservation (Kelly, Duarte and children). Your collaboration allows us to create content

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aspirational TOFU (reach) and BOFU Masterclasses (conversion), elevating the status of school.

●■ Hunter Jones

@hunterjoness.

Followers: 42,046.

Engagement rate: 7.9%.

Hunter Jones is an excellent fit for Saoloto Surf School as his focus on Lifestyle, Travel and Adventure aligns perfectly with the pillars of Community and Lifestyle & Performance of the school, especially attracting the Duarte personas (the beginner who sees surfing as a new adventure) and Kelly (who values community and experience). Its content, which is often inspirational and entertaining (TOFU), can create a community vibe, show the beauty of the area surrounding the school (Community) and promote surf camps and the experience of living surfing (Lifestyle), acting as a ambassador of Saoloto's relaxed and welcoming vibe.

2.3.2.3.1 Collaboration Strategy and Briefing

With the influencers selected and presented, and with the aim of making the more structured and coherent project, the collaboration strategy will then be explained, which focuses on how influencers will be integrated into the Saoloto ecosystem and, subsequently, how this collaboration will be communicated to them through the briefing.

Below, the Collaboration Strategy:

Category

Teresa Bonvalot

(Professional Athlete)

Hunter Jones

(Lifestyle Surf Vlogger)

Type of

Collaboration

Ambassador.

(Focus on authority and supply premium).

Affiliate/Content Creator.

(Focus on experience and discovery of school/place).

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Estimated Budget

High (From €2,500/€5,000 per campaign or fee for

Masterclass/presence, depending on exclusivity and time).

Medium (From €800/€1,500 per campaign, or collaboration by exchange/remuneration + free accommodation/classes).

Deliverables

Expected

- 1 in-person Masterclass

(BOFU/MOFU event).

- 1 Technical Reel/Short (e.g.: maneuver analysis).

- Use of affiliate link/code for surfing registrations camps.

- 2 Stories to support company events school/conservation action.

- 1 Long Video on YouTube about experience at Saoloto's Surf Camp.

- 2 daily Stories during your stay.

- Use of affiliate link/code to enrollment in surf camps.

Finally, the briefing:

Influencer: Teresa Bonvalot (Professional Athlete).

Campaign Objective:

- Sell places for the Saoloto Performance Masterclass (BOFU Conversion).

- Cement the Authority of Saoloto Surf School as an elite training center

(MOFU).

Talking Points:

-

Exclusive Content: Emphasize that the Masterclass offers video analysis, advanced wave reading and practical exercises she uses on the WSL circuit.



Limited places: Highlight the exclusivity of the training (small groups) and the personalized attention to optimize the technique (e.g. Bottom Turn and Cutback).



Evolution Happens Here: Positioning the Masterclass as the Step
Essential for intermediate/advanced surfers who want to break technical barriers.
Deliverables and Deadlines:

●■ Technical Reel/Short (Maneuver Analysis): (3 weeks before)

■ ■ Format: Reel (45s).

■ ■ Content: Teresa demonstrating and giving 3 quick tips on a maneuver
key (linked to the Masterclass training).

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- Launch and Support Stories: (1-2 weeks before)

- Content: Q&A; session about your routine and how the Masterclass will replicate it this training intensity. Include swipe up directly to the registration page.

- Code Usage: Promote her code to those who sign up (e.g.:

TERESASURF10)

CTA (Call to Action):

-

"Do you want to accelerate your evolution? Vacancies for my Masterclass in Performance at Saoloto is limited! Secure your spot and use my code [Code] to an exclusive discount. Registration link and all information in Saoloto's BIO!

#■Required Hashtags:

- #MasterclassSurf.

- #SurfPerformance.

- #TeresaBonvalot.

- #SaolotoSurfSchool.

- #EliteTraining

- #EvolveNoSurf.

Influencer: Hunter Jones (Lifestyle Surf Vlogger).

Campaign Objective:

- TOFU (Reach/Discovery): Show the school vibe, the beauty of the local community and the Saoloto Surf Camp experience.

- MOFU (Consideration): Generate leads and registrations for Surf Camps and surf classes initiation (Personas Duarte and Kelly).

Talking Points:

-

The Community Vibe: Focus on interaction with instructors and other students, showing the welcoming and relaxed atmosphere.

-

Complete Experience: Covering day-to-day life in the area: the quality of the waves to all levels, accommodation (if applicable) and post-surf activities (Community).

-

Ease for Travelers: Position Surf Camp as a "turnkey" ideal for those who want to start out or travel alone and be part of a group.

Deliverables and Deadlines:

- Long Video on YouTube: (Released 1 week after stay).

- Content: Detailed VLOG about Surf Camp, from check-in to hitting the waves.

Ideal duration: 5-8 minutes.

- 2 Daily Stories during your stay:

- Content: Show behind-the-scenes, local food reviews and interaction with the team. Focus on authenticity and fun.

- Use of Affiliate Link: Insert the Affiliate Link/Code in the description of the video YouTube and in Instagram BIO.

CTA (Call to Action):

-

"Do you want to live the same adventure as me in Portugal? Click on the link in description to reserve your place at Saoloto's Surf Camp and use my code [Code] for a special discount. See you in the water! ■■"

#■Required Hashtags:

- #SurfCampPortugal

- #SaolotoSurfVibe

- #HunterJonesTravel

- #SurfLifestyle

- #LearnASurf

- #ViagemSurf

2.3.3 Operationalization

2.3.3.1 Content Pillars

It is consensual that, both in light of the functioning of social media algorithms as well as the psychological principles underlying consumer decisions, consistency plays a central role in brand communication.

However, this consistency must be accompanied by relevance, since a communication that does not resonate with the target audience inevitably results in low levels of interaction, and consequently, a reduced impact on sales and construction of a solid community around the brand.

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It is in this context that the content pillars emerge. These are defined based on the competition analysis and consumer analysis, these two dimensions being fundamental to inform a brand entering the market on the topics, formats and narratives that generate greater engagement.

Furthermore, the content pillars attribute a clear purpose to communication, reducing dependence on constant and improvised ideation, and also promote a greater internal organization, as well as a capacity for advance planning that significantly facilitates the team's work.

In the case of Saoloto, this logic is no different, with the following pillars being defined of content:

Pillars:

- Surfing [Technical];
- Surfing [Material];
- Community;
- Conservation;
- Lifestyle & Performance.

Justification:



Surfing [technical]: meets our audience's need to evolve experienced (more or less) while allowing beginners (or those who have not yet started but intend to do so) become familiar with some concepts "high-level" (Impacts Lukas, Duarte and Kelly as they all benefit from "sharpening" their "skills").



Surf [Material]: seeks to provide tips on how to choose the material appropriate and at a later time how to take care of that same equipment. This pillar mostly covers beginners and inexperienced people but can be useful for those who already have experience but does not know certain techniques (This pillar falls mainly on Duarte and Kelly as they are those who are least familiar with the equipment).



Community: Community-focused content promotion seeks show both the school and the "classes" and visitors, there is also an effort to share the adjacent area as this business ends up being an integral part of the local community. (Pillar of

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community is consumed by all personas, were this not the main reason why “surf” with us).



Conservation: A surf school, and by extension the planet, cannot survive if the sea, which is its stage, is not in “conditions” it then becomes an effort focused on conserving the marine environment is imperative. The content focuses here in educating people about the problems plaguing the ocean. The education of our students, especially children and young people, would show the new generation to participate in conservation of our sea (The conservationist content mainly appeals to Lucas’ sensibilities because being Portuguese is the one with the most “skin in the game” so that the future of our seas is guaranteed).



Lifestyle & Performance: This pillar focuses on showing the day-to-day life of school and the “athletes” that make up it, “behind-the-scenes” is the main content and allows create a sense of community while fostering closeness between students and prospective students. The Lifestyle part mainly encompasses tips on how to live better while promoting the necessary habits for the surfer to always be on top of his game. better while practicing this sport. (Lifestyle/Performance will mainly interest to Lukas as he is the one who is most familiar with the surfer's day-to-day life and what it is necessary to maintain your condition at optimal levels, yet other personas may benefit from “tips”).

2.3.3.2 Types of Content

To ensure a dynamic and engaging digital presence, the content strategy of Saoloto Surf School is based on a balance between delivery formats. The priority is transmit the school's energy and community spirit, prioritizing movement in to the detriment of static.

Distribution by Content Pillars

The content will be divided equally to cover all phases of the customer journey. user, from discovery to loyalty:



25% Educational: Tips on surfing technique, safety at sea, reading predictions and equipment care.



25% Entertainment: Fun moments in classes, surfing lifestyle, challenges and the relaxed atmosphere of the school.



25% Inspirational: Aesthetic images of sunset sessions, stories of overcoming students and connecting with nature.



25% UGC (User Generated Content): Sharing content created by students and community members themselves, reinforcing social proof and authenticity.

Mix of Formats and Frequency

The choice of formats reflects the brand's identity. The feeling of community and the surfing adrenaline is not best manifested through static images, requiring the fluidity and sound of the video:

Format

Percentage

Main Objective

Reels

80%

Reach, dynamism and transmission of the company's "vibe" school.

Long Form

Video

10%

Detailed coverage of Surf Camps and events specials.

Carousels

5%

Step-by-step educational content or albums events.

Photos

5%

Specific announcements or photographic records of discharge quality.

The Reel, chosen as the "king" format (80%), is a strategic decision by

characteristics it presents:

1.

Videos tell the story better: Surfing is a sensorial and kinetics. Through video, we were able to convey the fluidity of the waves, the sound vibration of the sea and the genuine joy of the students. The "sense of community" that defines Saoloto manifests itself in movement and interaction, something that a static image cannot achieve capture in full.

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2.

Algorithms favor Reels: Currently, social platforms

(Instagram and TikTok) prioritize the Reels format in organic delivery. This format makes it easier to discovery of the brand by new audiences (awareness phase), ensuring that the brand's message Saoloto reaches potential surfers who do not yet follow the page (Image 28 in the annex).

2.3.3.3 Scheduling

Once the content pillars and formats to be adopted have been defined, the creation phase of the editorial calendar. Similar to the process of defining the pillars, the timing reinforces the organization and consistency of the strategy. With this structure, it is possible to predict the production, optimize resources and ensure that the brand message maintains its fluidity and relevance.

Below is the respective calendar:

Image 29 - Editorial Calendar, Notion by Saoloto

The application of the 80/20 rule was considered, since, as mentioned throughout

In this project, branding takes priority over performance. In this sense, 16.7% of content will be of a promotional nature (BOFU), while the remaining 83.3% will correspond valuable content, aimed at building a brand and relationships with the audience.

It is also important to emphasize that there is a concern in adapting the copy according to of each platform's target audience. According to several studies, namely those developed by DataReportal, a company specialized in analyzing the use of networks digital platforms at a global level, different platforms correspond to different audiences, as well as specific usage objectives.

When considering these differences, it is demonstrated, once again, that personalization is a valued and essential element for authentic, relevant and human communication of Saoloto.

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2.3.3.4 Exemplary Content

To illustrate the convergence between brand narrative and format strategy,

The concept of content designed for the king of strategy format is presented below.

This example applies the storytelling principles developed in point 2.2.4.1, focusing in the journey of overcoming and emotional connection, which are the core of Saoloto's message.

"Life Imitates Art"

The Narrative Logic (The "Why"): We use the "Association

Nostalgic." By connecting the brand to the film Surf's Up, we activate an emotional memory pre-existing in the client (the desire to belong to a "surf family"). The visual narrative of video combats the brand's antagonist (Ego/Perfectionism) through humor and vulnerability, proving that at Saoloto human connection is worth more than performance technique.

Concrete Example: Viral Split-Screen Reel

●■ Concept: Split screen. Top: Original scene from the film (Big Z teaching Cody). Bass: Students and instructors in penguin costumes recreate the scene frame-by-frame on the beach.

●■ Visual Script (30s):

■ 0-5s (The Lesson): At the top, Big Z gives instructions. Below, the instructor pushes the clumsy student in fact (Humor).

■ 5-15s (The Chaos): Synchronized fall into the sand + Appearance of "Chicken Joe" lost in the background.

■ 15-30s (The Connection): Cut to real laughter and group hugs. It shows that the film's "fiction" is Saoloto's reality.

●■ Subtitle (Copy):

■ Title: Any similarity is a coincidence... or not. ■

■ Body: At Saoloto, we take tribe seriously. We are inspired by the masters (and penguins) to prove that surfing is about unity and fun, not just competition. A technique is taught, the family is built.

■ CTA: From 0 to 10, does our Chicken Joe deserve an Oscar? ■

#SaolotoTribo #SurfsUpRealLife

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2.3.3.5 Cross Strategies

To conclude the operational phase of Saoloto Surf School, the following are presented: crossed strategies. These result from the direct crossing between internal factors (Forces and Weaknesses) and external factors (Opportunities and Threats) previously identified in the SWOT analysis, in point 2.1.1.1.

The objective is to convert theoretical analysis into concrete action vectors, demonstrating how the brand can capitalize on its strengths and opportunities, while mitigates risks and corrects vulnerabilities to grow sustainably in the market.

Below, the four types of strategies proposed for Saoloto are detailed:

Strategy

Relationship

Proposed action

OS

Strengths + Opportunities 5+2 - Creation of a class package for “Wave Poolers” where it is established the parallels between “indoor” and “wave pool” surfing and builds from there.

WO

Weaknesses +

Opportunities

2+3 - Our lack of notoriety can be overcome with a “push” intentional use of our social networks in order to try to achieve “virality” (by base, mass creation of TOFU content).

ST

Strengths + Threats

3+1 - In a situation where costs increase and the market consolidates Only those outfits that are best managed and with the most “value” survive. added.” The quality of our team sets us apart and can be expanded by offering discounts to those who leave an “opposing” school for ours.

WT

Weaknesses + Threats

4+1 ROI Optimization and Cost Control: Implement management “lean” operational focusing on high efficiency with reduced expenses. O objective is to absorb cost increases (Threat) through Reduction of

Waste (for example, carrying out preventive maintenance of the material) and Adopting High ROI Promotion Strategies, such as Marketing Reference (“Referral Marketing”) and the optimization of digital campaigns paid (if used) to ensure that every euro spent on advertising generates the highest possible return.

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2.3.4 Management and Feasibility

It is impossible to finish a project that aims to disrupt the market, in this case the surfing market, without demonstrating concern about its viability, as well as the care to be taken in the short term. This chapter aims to demonstrate which expenses expected at the budget level, so that any expectation, whether positive or negative, is according to the reality of the project.

Furthermore, it is important that any strategy has space for monitoring because, as already mentioned, nothing presented here can be taken as absolute. The normality of any project is that it presents flaws that will be overcome and eliminated over time.

2.3.4.1 Budget

The definition of the monthly investment for the Saoloto Surf School (SSS) is based on the "BUILD-UP" strategy, where values are allocated based on operational objectives necessary to make the project viable. The total expected investment is €1,050 per month, totaling €12,600 annually.

In terms of prioritization, the three most important channels for the brand are Meta Ads, Google Ads and the website, each contributing differently to the objective main:



Meta Ads: stands out for offering the greatest reach and best targeting, allowing you to scale quickly with a very high impact and relatively low effort. moderate, which makes it the channel most aligned with the need to grow and generate traffic qualified.



Google Ads: operates at the moment of greatest intention, capturing users who already actively seek solutions, which guarantees a consistent return, although it requires a more technical and continuous management.



Website: assumes the central role of the strategy, functioning as the main conversion point and the space where the brand presents all the information spread across different channels. Its impact depends on the quality of the experience provided and the capacity to convert traffic, being the channel that supports and receives all other communication initiatives.

Thus, the combination of these three channels ensures reach, intention and conversion of efficiently.

The defined allocations, as well as their respective justifications, can be found presented in the following table:

Channel

Investment

Monthly

Investment

Annual

%Total

Strategic Justification

Meta Ads

€150

€1,800

14.3%

Used to create awareness and raise awareness the brand to the desired target audiences.

Google Ads

€660

€7,920

62.86%

Acts in the consideration and conversion phases, directly influencing the profitability of the business through active searches.

Website

€40

€480

3.81%

Online "house" maintenance with a focus on SEO (on-page and off-page) and UX/UI optimization.

Photographer

€200

€2,400

19.05%

Capture
of
contents
authentic
for
use on social networks and other points of contact
contact.

There are other essential components for which a budget has not been allocated specific. Allocations made are based on market values and external services necessary for technical feasibility. However, the following pillars are managed in a distinct:



Social Media Management: This task is assumed as an internal function and organic brand. Although it requires planning time and effort, it does not represent a cost direct contracting of an external agency at this stage, with quality assured by Saoloto's internal structure.



Email Marketing: As previously mentioned, this tool will not have a paper at the beginning of the campaign, therefore there are no costs associated with it.

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PR (Public Relations): Public relations and contact with the press or local partners are carried out proactively and organically. The focus lies on building trust relationships and strategic partnerships that do not involve financial transactions direct.

In this way, allocations were defined based on available information about the market costs associated with specialized services, while the remaining components are classified as internal management resources or of a strictly organic, considered essential for the financial sustainability of the project.

2.3.4.2 Monitoring and Optimization

2.3.4.2.1 Metrics

As the strategy is designed to cover the three phases of the consumer journey, it is necessary that, in each of them, marketing efforts are analyzed, in order to identify which tactics present positive results, which require adjustments and that others can be explored to generate improvements.

Thus, the six metrics necessary for this exercise will be distributed in a balanced by the three phases:

TOFU



CCR (Cultural Content Reach) - Cultural Content Reach, specifically content that “leans in” to Saoloto’s Samoan roots.



BSV (Branded Search Volume) - Search Volume for terms such as: Saoloto, Saoloto Surf School, Saoloto Surf, Saoloto School, etc... (Allows you to evaluate the level of “awareness” that people have of the brand).

MOFU



AToP (Average Time on Page) - Average time visitors spend on our page (or pages) allows us to perceive interest and at the same time evaluate the level of optimization of these same pages.



CGR (Community Growth Rate) - Measures the percentage of growth of subscribers in the “tribe” and loyalty channels (such as the Newsletter, Reddit or Groups

Private). Allows you to evaluate how many users are moving from being just observers to become active members who want to belong to the Saoloto family.

BOFU



CVR (Conversion Rate) - The percentage of website visitors who effectively finalize the purchase of a class or service. Being a new brand, this metric is crucial to validating whether the “Samoan spirit” narrative is convincing enough to lead to immediate commercial action.



CLV (Customer Lifetime Value) – The total monetary value a student generates throughout their relationship with the school (recurring classes, rentals, merchandising, “Surf Camps”). It is the fundamental metric to ensure that Saoloto is not just an attraction “single use” tourist destination, but rather a brand that creates lasting relationships and loyalty.

2.3.4.2.2 Analysis Tools

For these metrics to be analyzed effectively, it is necessary to use tools that make this process more practical. In this sense, those considered most suitable for analyzing the metrics mentioned above, according to each phase of the funnel, are the following:



Meta Business (+ Meta Ads) ➡ ■ CCR

With Facebook and Instagram (both from Meta) being two of the strongest platforms in terms of reach and engagement due to its characteristics (DataReportal) is important use the tools that Meta Business has to analyze the results of campaigns, whether paid ads (Paid Media) or organic efforts (Owned Media).



Google Analytics (+ Looker Studio) ➡ ■ AToP; CVR; CLV

The website will be the central measurement platform for the entire marketing strategy. Since conversions occur at the site level and traffic coming from other platforms ends its journey at this point, it is essential that all analysis is concentrated in a single tool, ensuring an integrated and coherent view of performance.

To achieve this, it will be necessary to build data bridges between platforms, through of Google Tag Manager, a tool that allows you to implement and manage tracking code,

ensuring correct communication and data collection throughout the entire ecosystem digital.



Google Search Console ➡■ BSV;

In order to understand how Saoloto Surf School is searched for on the internet, this tool allows you to analyze the search terms used by users, the position average of the brand's website in organic results and how these results evolve over time. It is especially relevant for the analysis and optimization of organic performance and website SEO strategy.



Mod Insights ("Community Health" dashboard) ➡■ CGR;

It is a native tool for the channel on Reddit, one of the platforms used for the construction and management of the Saoloto community. This community is made up by an audience that already understands the brand's positioning and shows interest in be part of your ecosystem.

The tool allows you to analyze the performance of publications on this network, namely audience interactions, activity levels, community growth and other relevant metrics to assess community health and engagement throughout of time.

2.3.4.2.3 Diagnosis - Problems and Optimizations

This point aims to demonstrate the team's critical capacity in anticipate and mitigate potential problems, demonstrating a strategic vision that goes beyond the idealized planning. Although the risk scenarios are varied, three were identified possibilities for which Saoloto Surf School presents answers in advance outlined.

1st Problem:

●■ AToP (Avg. Time on Page) very high on the "History" and "Legends" pages.

●■ Very low CVR (Conversion Rate).

Website visitors spend a fairly healthy amount of time on pages that contain authentic and genuine content about the history and legends of surfing, unfortunately the conversion rate remains very low.

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Optimization: People are immersed in reading the Samoan spirit (which explains time on the page high), but the site works like a museum: the user reads, gets inspired, and goes although because the buy button disappeared up there.

Implement a "Sticky CTA Button" that floats on top or bottom of the screen and follows the user's scroll. This ensures that the "Book Class" is always visible at the exact moment the user feels inspired by the story, without breaking the fluidity of reading.

2nd Problem:

- High CCR (Cultural Content Reach) and CGR (Community Growth).

- Low BSV (Branded Search Volume) in the school's local area.

In this situation, cultural content demonstrates solid performance. O its consumption and distribution contribute positively to the growth of the community. No However, this growth may occur mainly in international markets where the Demand for surfing is not particularly high.

Even though Saoloto positions itself as an international school, (considering that the language of surfing is universal) there are markets where the demand for this practice is extremely limited. Thus, a community composed largely of percentage by individuals coming from these markets will hardly translate into conversions.

Optimization: The social platforms algorithm is optimizing the distribution of content to where "taste" is cheaper and more abundant, ignoring the likelihood of actual purchase. The budget is paying for vanity metrics in markets that do not consume the product. Implement a "Negative Geo-Targeting" strategy (Exclusion Geographic) in top-of-funnel campaigns.

Markets identified as bearish must be explicitly added propensity for cold water surfing to the list of excluded locations. This forces the algorithm to redistribute the budget to markets with compatible surf culture (such as Japan, USA or Northern Europe), exchanging volume of followers for quality of potential customers.

3rd Problem:

- High BSV (Branded Search Volume) (many people search for the brand).

- CVR (Conversion Rate) drops specifically for beginners.
- Neutral/confused BSS (Brand Sentiment) in the comments (“Is this just for pros?”).

This scenario generally occurs in brands that rely heavily on history and surfing legends, which can lead the potential client, in this case the beginner, to perceive the brand as excessively cool or hardcore.

Despite there being a high volume of searches associated with the brand, the rate of conversion of this segment is residual. Additionally, the dominant feeling is one of confusion, since it is not clear whether the school is aimed exclusively at experienced surfers or whether also welcomes beginners. This ambiguity, often reflected in the comments of publications, tends to alienate this more inexperienced audience.

Optimizations:

1st – The isolated interest in “Surf” or “Polynesian Culture” is excessively comprehensive for an international surf school. A user can identify with the Saoloto vibe without ever leaving its home country. In international markets, the Segmentation must therefore resort to Travel Intent Layering, crossing interest in “Surf” with mandatory behaviors such as “Frequent International Travelers” or “Interest in Travel to Portugal”.

This approach allows us to filter out the so-called “couch fans” and ensure that the narrative of Samoan Legend is only delivered to users who, statistically, demonstrate propensity and financial capacity to travel to school.

2nd – The iconography associated with “Warriors” and “Ancestral Legends” is creating a psychological barrier to entry, implicitly suggesting that error, failure or lack of dexterity are not welcome in the “tribe”. To mitigate this effect, it is recommended to implementation of a content humanization strategy (The Smiling Warrior). This involves creating an editorial line of videos (Reels/TikToks) and testimonials that show real beginners falling, laughing and learning in a safe environment accompanied by instructors.

By visually normalizing the learning process, reinforcing that “everything warrior starts from scratch”, the perception of elitism is reduced and the school is validated with the amateur audience, particularly in the comments section.

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3rd – The current website, excessively focused on Saoloto's philosophy and symbolism, does not answer the practical doubts and critical insecurities of those who have never had contact with the surfing (fear of the sea, technical difficulties, equipment, safety), leading to abandonment in moment of decision. It is recommended to develop a Landing Page dedicated to beginners (Zero-Friction Page), which replaces abstraction with clarity.

This page should deconstruct the experience step by step ("What will you learn in your 1st class"), explicitly ensure that safety and equipment are included and use reassuring language. The objective is for it to function as a "safe haven" within the site, converting curiosity (high BSV) into trust and effective booking (CVR).

A/B Testing

As one of the services, aimed at the Portuguese market, is a class subscription, the A/B test variable will be the price presentation format. Regardless of whether the user selects a 3, 6 or 12 month package, the possibility test is whether the monetary value of the service should be shown as a monthly fee or as single payment.

The central metric will be the number of clicks on the chosen preference, allowing identify which of the two presentations generates greater traction. The objective is to understand which format that the public values most and, based on that, automatically adopt the option with better CTR, reducing the number of clicks needed to convert.

In summary, the 360° knowledge that the team has about the project. Although this is a fictitious exercise, the main issues inherent to the pre-launch, launch and post-launch phases, having these have been critically framed and, whenever possible, accompanied by proposals for solution.

2.3.4.2.4 Results - Dashboard Structure

The dashboard was designed to monitor the performance of the marketing throughout the entire funnel. The structure is organized into five main sections, for funnel phase, ensuring clear and organized reading.

●■ Section 1: Overview (General Performance)

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This section presents an executive summary of the global state of marketing and business, allowing you to quickly understand whether the strategy is aligned with the objectives.

Metrics included:

- ■ Total Sales: Total number of sales generated in the analyzed period.
- ■ CVR – Conversion Rate: Percentage of visitors who complete a purchase.
- ■ CAC – Customer Acquisition Cost: Average cost to acquire a new customer, resulting from the division between investment in marketing and number of new customers.
- ■ CLV – Customer Lifetime Value: Total value expected per customer throughout of your relationship with the brand.
- ■ Retention/NPS: Indicators of quality of experience and loyalty (included when data exists).

Section Objective:

Provide a macro view of marketing efficiency, traffic quality and the profitability of customer acquisition.

● ■ Section 2: TOFU – Awareness and Cultural Reach

Focused on the top of the funnel, this section analyzes brand awareness and impact of cultural content, a central element of Saoloto's positioning.

Metrics included:

- ■ CCR – Cultural Content Reach: Total reach of cultural content associated with Samoan roots.
- ■ BSV – Branded Search Volume: Direct search volume by terms related to the brand, an indicator of spontaneous awareness.
- ■ Total Impressions: Total number of impressions generated in the main social platforms.
- ■ Cultural Engagement Rate: Percentage of interactions generated by cultural contents.
- ■ New Visitors (Website): Number of new visitors to the website, useful for realize the effectiveness of awareness campaigns.

Section Objective:

Assess brand visibility, cultural impact of content and brand growth spontaneous search.

●■ Section 3: MOFU – Consideration and Community

This phase analyzes the behavior of users who have already shown interest, measuring depth of content consumption and community generation capacity.

Metrics included:

■ ■ AToP – Average Time on Page: Average time that users remain on each relevant page.

■ ■ Scroll Depth: Percentage of content actually viewed per page.

■ ■ CTR (Campaigns / Key Content): Indicator of effectiveness of messages in generating actions.

■ ■ CGR – Community Growth Rate: Community growth rate in loyalty channels (newsletter, Reddit, private groups).

■ ■ Lead Capture Rate: Percentage of visitors who leave contact or register.

Section Objective:

Measure real interest, quality of website experience and ability to convert users into community members.

Section 4: BOFU – Conversion and Value

Critical zone of the funnel, dedicated to analyzing commercial performance and efficiency in value generation.

Metrics included:

■ ■ CR – Conversion Rate: Rate of conversion of visitors into buyers.

■ ■ Checkout Abandonment Rate: Percentage of users who initiate the checkout but do not complete the purchase.

■ ■ CAC – Customer Acquisition Cost: Reevaluated specifically at this stage for a clear perception of profitability.

■ ■ ROI: Indicator of total economic return, after subtracting the investment.

■ ■ CLV – Customer Lifetime Value: Key metric to evaluate the sustainability and longevity of the relationship with the customer.

Section Objective:

Ensure that the commercial structure is efficient, identify leak points in the journey purchasing process and analyze the economic value generated.

● ■ Section 5: Retention & Loyalty

A post-purchase section that complements the analysis, allowing you to understand longevity, repetition and customer loyalty.

Metrics included:

■ ■ Repeat Purchase Rate: Percentage of customers who purchase again.

■ ■ Average Time Between Purchases: Average interval between successive purchases.

■ ■ NPS – Net Promoter Score: Indicator of satisfaction and probability of recommendation.

Section Objective:

Assess the brand's ability to generate lasting relationships, promote repetition and build an active and loyal community.

3. Conclusion

The development of this project, focused on the creation and go-to-market strategy of Saoloto Surf School, allowed us to follow a complex itinerary that transformed a initial idea into a tangible, differentiated and operationally viable business model. Throughout the various stages of this Business Case, we sought not only to structure a school of surfing, but building a brand with soul, capable of responding to the challenges of a market saturated through a unique value proposition: the fusion between Samoan spiritual heritage and the hospitality of Costa da Caparica.

The initial phase of strategic diagnosis proved to be fundamental to support all subsequent decisions. The application of the 4C's framework allowed us to deconstruct the scenario current competitive environment, where a clear saturation of the offer focused on performance was identified technology and mass tourism. The validation of Costa da Caparica as a physical location, to the detriment of Cascais, it was not just a geographical choice, but a decision to positioning: authenticity, wild nature and space for grow, moving the brand away from congested urban centers where the surfing "vibe" is lost in excessive commercialization. This analysis confirmed that although there are 678 schools surfing in Portugal, there is a blue ocean for anyone who sets out to sell not just lessons, but belonging.

The construction of the brand identity, materialized in the Brand Guidelines, was the turning point that allowed Saoloto to stop being a theoretical project and come to life own. The definition of the name "Saoloto" (Freedom) and the motto "Where the Waves Carve Family" served as a compass for all tactical choices. As we focus on branding human and community, we respond directly to the pain identified in our personas.

For Lukas, the experienced traveler, we offer the cultural depth that is missing in commercial schools; For Kelly, the independent woman, we guarantee safety and security welcoming a non-intimidating environment; and for Duarte, the local young man, we created a space of formation and identity. This psychographic segmentation, more than demographic, ensures that Saoloto communicates with emotional relevance, a critical factor in converting interest in loyalty in a market where the barrier to entry for the consumer is, many times, Sometimes, the fear of not belonging.

The Marketing Mix strategy (7Ps) and the communication ecosystem (POEM) demonstrated the ability to operationalize this philosophical vision. The decision to adopt a Competitive Pricing strategy in the Upper-Middle segment, supported by a strong digital presence and partnerships with influencers such as Teresa Bonvalot and Hunter Jones, positions Saoloto as an affordable premium offering.

We don't sell the lowest price, we sell the highest perceived value: the down payment in a tribe. The structure of the ecosystem, from the top of the funnel with lifestyle content and storytelling (like the "Big Z" narrative) to conversion via Google Ads and Website optimized, proves that the brand is prepared to capture, nurture and convert leads in a efficient. The focus on video (Reels) and social proof (UGC) reflects an understanding deep understanding of the consumption habits of the Millennial and Gen Z generations, ensuring that the brand keeps it relevant and visible where consumer attention currently resides.

From a feasibility and management point of view, the plan presented is realistic and conservative. The Build-Up budget strategy, focused on the essentials for the start-up, combined with to a rigorous control panel (Dashboard), allows constant monitoring of health of the business.

Defining clear SMART objectives, from initial awareness to conversion rate retention in Surf Camps, guarantees that management will not be done by intuition, but by data. We are prepared to monitor Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC) and Lifetime Value (LTV) from day one, allowing agile adjustments if the market reacts appropriately different than expected.

Cross-strategies (SWOT) also demonstrated that Saoloto has planned resilience, with responses prepared for seasonality or aggressiveness of the competition, such as betting on packages for "Wave Poolers" or loyalty through quality of service.

More than a business plan, this project presents a cultural manifesto.

In an increasingly digital and isolated world, where surfing runs the risk of becoming just yet another fitness industry, Saoloto Surf School proposes a return to its origins. Proposes May the sea once again be a place of worship and connection.

The conclusion we reached is that the viability of this project does not only lie in the quality of its waves or its boards, but in the strength of the community that aims to

to create. If the market demands performance, Saoloto delivers experience; if the market sells isolation, Saoloto delivers family.

In short, Saoloto Surf School meets all the strategic, financial and operations to assert itself as a reference player in Costa da Caparica and, on average, term, in the national panorama of surf tourism. The work developed here proves that it is possible to combine the passion for the sea with the rigor of marketing management, creating a brand that is, simultaneously a profitable business and a spiritual refuge. We are ready to open doors, enter the water and begin to carve, wave by wave, our family.

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5. ANNEX

Image 1 - Strategic Analysis Organization Framework

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Image 2 - Data on surfers in the national territory, Portugal.

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Image 3 - Best times of year to surf, by continent/country/type of surfer.

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Image 4 - Cascais Coast, mostly made up of cliffs, cliffs, urban areas or marinas.

Image 5 - Beaches closest to the urban center (own authorship)

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Image 6 - Beaches further away from the urban core (own authorship)

image 7 - Surf Schools in Costa da Caparica, image from Google Maps.

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Image 28 - Best formats in the different stages of the funnel, Linkedin publication

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